



2026 EDITION

The Richmond Relocation Guide

Neighborhood-level expertise. Real data. No fluff.

By Miles Agee / MAMS Real Estate



A NOTE FROM MILES

Before you start reading.

I didn't make this guide to give you the same information you'd find on Google. You can search "best neighborhoods in Richmond" and get a dozen listicles written by someone who's never driven down Cary Street.

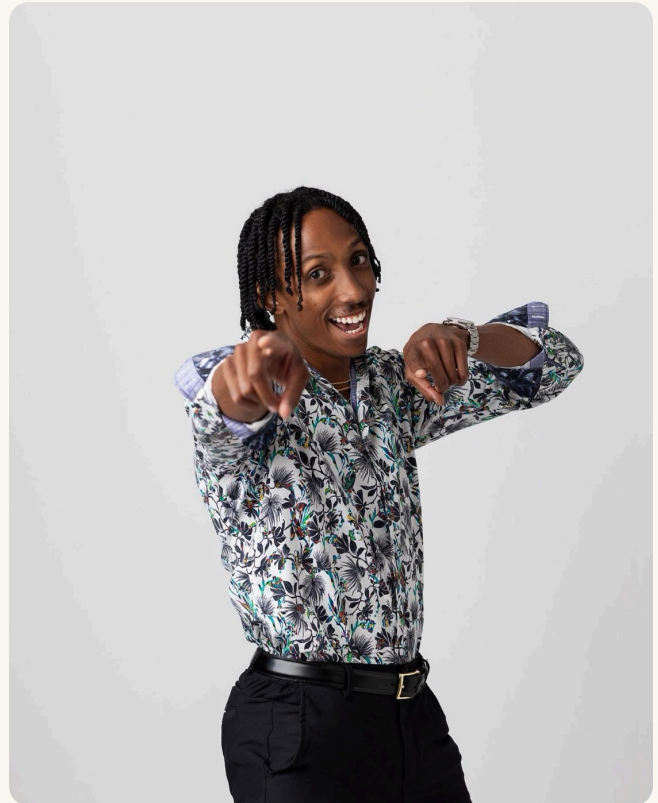
I made this because choosing where to live is one of the biggest decisions you'll make, and you deserve someone who actually knows the difference between Church Hill and the Fan at 7pm on a Tuesday. Someone who can tell you which blocks in Church Hill smell like fresh bread from Sub Rosa on Saturday mornings, and which streets in Manchester give you a skyline view you didn't know existed.

I've helped over 60 families find their place in Richmond. Some came from Northern Virginia. Some from California. Some moved across town. Every single one of them had a different version of "home" in their head, and my job was to match that vision to the right block, not just the right zip code.

That's what this guide does. It goes deeper than most agents are willing to go because most agents don't know Richmond at this level. I do.

Use this guide to narrow your search. Then let's talk. I'll fill in the parts that only come from walking the streets and closing the deals.

Miles Agee



WHAT'S INSIDE

Table of Contents

PART 1: WHY RICHMOND

Why Richmond? The Data	04
Why Richmond? The Lifestyle	06
Richmond At A Glance	08
Who Is This Guide For?	10

PART 2: RICHMOND CITY

Living in Richmond City	13
The Fan & Museum District	14
Church Hill	16
Scott's Addition	18
Jackson Ward	20
Manchester	22
Byrd Park & Carytown	24
Shockoe Bottom	26
Fulton & Rocketts Landing	27
Northside Neighborhoods	28
More City Neighborhoods	29
James River Deep Dive	31
City Parks	33
Schools in Richmond City	34
City Neighborhood Comparison	35

PART 3: THE SUBURBS

Suburban Overview & Comparison	36
Short Pump & Glen Allen	38
Midlothian & Moseley	45
Mechanicsville	52
Exploring Further Out	57

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Cost of Living Breakdown	59
Transportation & Getting Around ...	61
Healthcare & Hospitals	63
Weather & Climate	64
Relocation Checklist	65
Virginia Tax Guide	67
Richmond Food & Drink Guide	69
Annual Events Calendar	71

PART 5: YOUR NEXT STEP

5 Steps to Finding Your Place	73
What MAMS Clients Say	75
About Miles	76
Start a Conversation	77

Questions before you even start reading? Tell me what you're trying to figure out and I'll point you to the right section. mamsnow.com/connect

PART 1: WHY RICHMOND

Why Richmond? The Data.

Richmond took in 60,000 new residents since 2020, and cost of living still runs 7-15% under the metros most of them left. Here's how the numbers stack up.

How Richmond Compares

METRIC	RICHMOND	WASHINGTON DC	CHARLOTTE	RALEIGH	NASHVILLE
Median Home Price	\$380K	\$650K+	\$420K	\$465K	\$485K
Avg. 1BR Rent	\$1,400	\$2,300+	\$1,550	\$1,500	\$1,650
Median Household Income	\$81K	\$101K	\$72K	\$80K	\$70K
COL Index (US = 100)	93	152	101	103	105
Sales Tax	6.0%	6.0%	7.25%	7.25%	9.55%
State Income Tax	2-5.75%	4-10.75%	4.5%	4.5%	0%
Unemployment Rate	3.1%	4.2%	3.6%	3.3%	3.0%

What this means for you: A family moving from the DC metro to Richmond gains \$150K-\$270K in home equity for the same square footage, lower taxes, and a 20-minute commute instead of 60.

Richmond's Economy

FORTUNE 500 COMPANIES

- Altria Group
- CarMax
- Dominion Energy
- Genworth Financial
- Performance Food Group

MAJOR EMPLOYERS

- Capital One (major regional hub)
- VCU Health System
- Bon Secours Mercy Health
- Federal Reserve Bank
- Virginia State Government

Metro population: 1.3 million | Growth: +60,000 since 2020 | Unemployment: 3.1%

Big-City Access. Without the Price Tag.

Richmond sits at the intersection of I-95 and I-64, two hours from DC, 90 minutes from the beach, and an hour from wine country. You get the career opportunities and cultural depth of a major metro without paying major metro prices.

1.3M

METRO POPULATION

93

COL INDEX (US=100)

5

FORTUNE 500 HQS

35+

DIRECT FLIGHTS (RIC)



Photo: Wikimedia Commons / CC BY 3.0

If you work remotely: Richmond is becoming a top WFH hub. Lower cost of living means your salary stretches further. Co-working spaces are expanding rapidly. Fiber internet (Fios) covers most of the

PART 1: WHY RICHMOND

Why Richmond? The Lifestyle.

The James River

Most cities charge for outdoor experiences this good. Richmond's are free. The James River Park System offers over 20 miles of trails for hiking, mountain biking, and running, all within city limits. Kayak through Class III-IV rapids downtown. Sunbathe on the flat rocks at Belle Isle. Bike the Virginia Capital Trail, 52 paved miles from Richmond to Williamsburg through some of the most scenic countryside in Virginia.

Food & Drink

Richmond is a legitimate top-tier food city. Multiple James Beard Award semifinalists call RVA home. Over 30 craft breweries are concentrated in walkable districts. The restaurant scene runs from Southern comfort food at Mama J's to Brenner Pass to modern Chinese at Fat Dragon. And unlike bigger cities, you can still get a table on a Friday night.

Arts & Culture

The Virginia Museum of Fine Arts (VMFA) is free. Not discounted on Tuesdays, free. The National hosts major touring acts. First Fridays Art Walk fills Jackson Ward with galleries, food, and live music monthly. VCU's art school is ranked top 5 nationally, and the creative energy spills into every neighborhood. Richmond raised Arthur Ashe, the tennis legend and humanitarian whose statue stands on Monument Avenue. The Black History Museum and Cultural Center of Virginia anchors the city's deep African American heritage.

Weekend Proximity

Charlottesville — 1 hour (wine country, UVA)
Virginia Beach — 1.5 hours (coast)
Washington DC — 2 hours (culture, career)
Blue Ridge Mountains — 2 hours (hiking, scenic)
Outer Banks — 3.5 hours (beach vacation)

Frequent traveler? Richmond International Airport (RIC) offers 35+ direct destinations. Amtrak runs direct to DC in 2 hours and NYC in 5.

A City You Experience, Not Just Live In.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons / CC BY 3.0

OUTDOOR ADVENTURES

- Belle Isle (rocks, trails, swimming)
- Pony Pasture (kayaking, tubing)
- Maymont Park (100 acres, free)
- Capital Trail (52-mile bike path)
- Kings Dominion (theme park)

CULTURE & NIGHTLIFE

- VMFA (free admission)
- The National (live music)
- Byrd Theatre (1928 landmark)
- First Fridays Art Walk
- Rooftop bars & speakeasies
- Drive Shack & Top Golf

FAMILY FUN

- Science Museum of Virginia
- Children's Museum
- Lewis Ginter Botanical Garden
- Metro Richmond Zoo
- Deep Run Park (playgrounds)
- Farmers markets (weekly)

Ready to find your neighborhood? Keep reading, or skip ahead to the area that interests you most.

Richmond At A Glance

This is a detailed map of the Richmond, Virginia metropolitan area. The map shows a dense network of roads, with major highways highlighted in orange and labeled with their respective numbers: US 522, US 250, SR 617, SR 711, US 60, SR 604, SR 606, VA 33, VA 156, VA 155, VA 5, VA 153, and SR 602. Key locations and neighborhoods are labeled throughout the map, including Ashland, Hanover, Central Garage, Horse, King William, Goochland, Wyndham, Short Pump, Glen Allen, Elmont, Laurel, Chamberlayne, Lakeside, Mechanicsville, Tuckahoe, Manakin-Sabot, River Road, Powhatan, Midlothian, Bon Air, Manchester, Rockwood, Meadowbrook, Varina, Sandston, Montrose, Highland Springs, Quinton, Providence Forge, Brandermill, Woodlake, Chula, Chesterfield, Chester, Enon, Hopewell, Charles City, Courthouse Road, Radnor Road, Pocahontas Trail, and Genito Road. The James River is depicted as a prominent blue feature winding through the city center. Other geographical features include various parks and green spaces shown in light green. The map also includes labels for specific roads like Mountain Road, Ashland Road, Strudley Road, Majdens Road, sby Road, Hull Street Road, Beach Road, and River Road.

**Mechanicsville / Moseley /
Goochland**

More land, lower prices, small-town feel. 25-40 min to downtown. Best value per square foot.

Quick Reference: Every Area at a Glance

AREA	MEDIAN PRICE	TAX RATE	SCHOOL DISTRICT	COMMUTE	BEST FOR
The Fan	\$650K	\$1.20	Richmond City PS	5 min	Walkability, nightlife
Church Hill	\$350-550K	\$1.20	Richmond City PS	10 min	History, character
Scott's Addition	\$400-550K	\$1.20	Richmond City PS	5 min	Young professionals
Manchester	\$415K	\$1.20	Richmond City PS	8 min	Investors, waterfront
Jackson Ward	\$380-475K	\$1.20	Richmond City PS	5 min	Culture, community
Short Pump	\$510K+	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	20 min	Families, shopping
Glen Allen	\$475-575K	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	18 min	Families, newer homes
Midlothian	\$420-500K	\$0.89	Chesterfield County PS	20 min	Value, families
Moseley	\$450-550K	\$0.89	Chesterfield County PS	30 min	Master-planned, space
Mechanicsville	\$375-450K	\$0.81	Hanover County PS	25 min	Affordability, space
Goochland	\$500K+	\$0.53	Goochland County PS	35 min	Land, privacy

Tax rates shown per \$100 of assessed value. Commute times to downtown Richmond during non-peak hours. Prices reflect 2025-2026 market data. For school performance data, visit doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org.

Not sure where to start? If walkability and culture are your priority, start with Richmond City (p.13). If you want more space and newer homes, look at the suburbs starting on page 36. Each area has its own character.

PART 1: WHY RICHMOND

Who Is This Guide For?

Everyone's version of "home" looks different. Here's how Richmond delivers for each of you.

Relocating From Out of State?

You're comparing Richmond to DC, Charlotte, Raleigh, or Nashville. Good. Richmond gives you 20-40% lower housing costs, comparable job markets, and a lifestyle those cities can't match at this price point. Start with the comparison table on page 4, then dive into neighborhoods.

Remote Worker?

Your salary goes 15-30% further here. Richmond has expanding co-working spaces, Fios fiber internet in most areas, and coffee shops worth working from in every neighborhood. You get big-city culture on a mid-market budget. Check the Fan (p.14), Scott's Addition (p.18), or Short Pump (p.38) for the best WFH lifestyle fit.

Growing Family?

Schools are probably your first filter. Each county runs its own independent school district: Henrico, Chesterfield, and Hanover. Research performance data at doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org before narrowing your search. Jump to the suburb comparison on page 36.

Young Professional?

You want walkability, nightlife, and a neighborhood with energy. The Fan, Scott's Addition, and Church Hill deliver urban living at 40% less than comparable DC neighborhoods. Breweries, restaurants, and live music are all walking distance. Start with Richmond City on page 13.

Downsizing or Retiring?

Virginia has no estate tax. Richmond has two full hospital systems, VCU Health and Bon Secours, and every suburb sits within 15 minutes of one. Quieter suburbs like Glen Allen and Midlothian offer single-level living near shopping and medical facilities. The James River and Maymont Park give you outdoor lifestyle without the crowds. See Healthcare on page 63 and the suburb profiles starting on page 36.

How To Use This Guide

You don't have to read this cover to cover. Use it as a reference. Here's the fastest path to the information you need.

If you know nothing about Richmond...

Start at the beginning. Pages 4-10 give you the full picture: cost of living, economy, lifestyle, and who Richmond is best for. Then move into the neighborhoods.

If you want city living...

Jump to Part 2 (page 13). Every major Richmond City neighborhood gets its own profile with pricing, vibe, dining, and a "best for" summary.

If you want suburban school districts...

Start with the Suburban Overview on page 36. Each county operates its own independent school district. The comparison table shows you every suburb side-by-side. Then dive into the one that fits.

If you need the practical stuff...

Part 4 (page 59) covers everything Google doesn't tell you: Virginia DMV transfers, personal property tax on vehicles (yes, that's a thing), utility setup, healthcare systems, and a month-by-month moving timeline.

If you're ready to talk...

Skip to page 77. Tell me your lifestyle, budget, and priorities, and I'll match them to the right neighborhoods before you ever look at a listing.

Richmond is one of Virginia's most historically and culturally diverse metros. For detailed population and demographic data on any area, visit the U.S. Census Bureau at data.census.gov. School information directs readers to independent third-party sources. MAMS LLC does not rate, rank, or endorse any school or school district. Equal Housing Opportunity.

PART 2

Richmond City

Every neighborhood has a story. We know them well enough to turn yours into the right strategy and the right deal.



Photo: Mobilus In Mobili / CC BY 2.0

PART 2: RICHMOND CITY

Living in Richmond City

The brick sidewalks and the rowhouses are real. What the postcards leave out is that you can walk from a Fan rowhouse to a rapid on the James in about twenty minutes, which is not a thing you can do in Charlotte, Raleigh, or Nashville.

If you want walkability, culture, and quick access to everything RVA has to offer, Richmond City should be at the top of your list. The tradeoff: higher property taxes (\$1.20 per \$100 of assessed value vs. \$0.81-\$0.89 in the suburbs). Each surrounding county operates its own independent school district. For school performance data, visit doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org.

For demographic data including population, income, age, and diversity statistics for any Richmond neighborhood, visit data.census.gov.

City Living Highlights

- Walkable neighborhoods with distinct personalities
- James River Park System (over 20 miles of trails)
- Richmond's best restaurants, bars, and cultural venues
- Historic architecture: rowhouses, Victorians, Craftsmans
- Arts scene anchored by VMFA and VCU's top-5 art school
- 5-10 minute commute to downtown from most neighborhoods

What to Know

- **Property Tax:** \$1.20 per \$100 assessed value
- **A \$400K home** = \$4,800/year in property taxes
- **Public Schools:** Richmond City Public Schools (visit doe.virginia.gov for data)
- **Parking:** Can be limited in Fan, Jackson Ward, Carytown
- **Median Home Price:** Varies widely by neighborhood (\$300K-\$650K+)
- **Rental Market:** \$1,400-\$1,850+ depending on neighborhood

Miles's take: Richmond City is where the personality is. Every neighborhood has its own energy, its own restaurants, its own identity. I've walked these blocks hundreds of times, and I can tell you exactly what it feels like to live on any given street. The next 20 pages go deep on every major neighborhood, with real data and honest assessments. No fluff.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

The Fan & Museum District

Richmond's flagship urban neighborhoods. If you want walkability, history, and a front-row seat to the city's best nightlife and dining, this is it.

The Fan gets its name from the fan-shaped street layout radiating westward from downtown. It's one of the largest intact Victorian neighborhoods in the country, with block after block of brick rowhouses, tree-lined sidewalks, and Monument Avenue's grand boulevard. The adjacent Museum District wraps around the Virginia Museum of Fine Arts (VMFA) and offers a slightly quieter, greener version of the same walkable lifestyle.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Median Sale Price:** \$650,000
- **Price per Sq Ft:** \$304-\$329
- **Median Rent:** \$1,850/month (+16% YoY)
- **Days on Market:** 37-46 days
- **Inventory:** Tight. 57 homes for sale (+16% YoY but still limited)
- **Trend:** Premium pricing sustained by consistent demand



Photo: Adam Jones, CC BY-SA 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

The Fan & Museum District continued

ARCHITECTURE

Early 20th-century rowhouses dominate, with Victorian, Colonial Revival, Craftsman, and Tudor Revival styles throughout. Monument Avenue features some of Richmond's grandest homes. Museum District adds more bungalows and Cape Cods. Expect character: original hardwood floors, exposed brick, and front porches built for neighbors.

DINING & NIGHTLIFE

- **Main Street:** Bar-hopping and live music corridor
- **Cary Street:** Brunch spots, coffee shops, boutiques
- **Can Can Brasserie:** French bistro, Richmond institution
- **Kuba Kuba:** Cuban cafe, perpetual line (worth it)
- **Lillie Pearl:** Southern-Asian fusion, Chef Mike Lindsey (305 Brook Rd)
- **The Jasper:** Best cocktail bar in the city, no debate

WALKABILITY

Excellent. Walk to restaurants, bars, Carytown shopping, VMFA, VCU campus, and Byrd Park. Most residents ditch the car for daily life.

CULTURE

- Virginia Museum of Fine Arts (free admission, no ticket needed)
- VCU campus energy (top 5 art school nationally)
- Historic Robinson House (part of VMFA, under restoration)
- Independent bookstores, record shops, galleries

BEST FOR

Young professionals, couples, anyone who prioritizes walkability and urban energy. Also popular with VCU faculty and hospital staff (VCU Health is nearby). If you want to walk to everything and live in a neighborhood with genuine character, this is the top choice in Richmond.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Street parking can be brutal, especially on weekends. Homes are older, which means maintenance costs. City property tax rate (\$1.20/100) is the highest in the region. Research school options at doe.virginia.gov. Noise from Main Street nightlife can carry into adjacent blocks.

Fitness in the polygon: 7 verified gyms, the densest fitness inventory of any city neighborhood. Anchors: Gold's Gym on Harvie, F45 on West Broad, Niche Pilates, re+forme (lagree), BOHO Studios, Richmond BJJ, Cary Street Gym at VCU. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Church Hill

Richmond's oldest neighborhood and its fastest-rising. Church Hill is where American history lives alongside some of the city's best restaurants and most ambitious renovations.

This is where it all started. In 1737, William Byrd II surveyed this hilltop overlooking the James River and named it Richmond. In 1775, Patrick Henry delivered his "Give me liberty or give me death" speech at St. John's Church, attended by Thomas Jefferson and George Washington. That church still stands. So does the neighborhood's spirit.

Church Hill contains several distinct sub-neighborhoods: Chimborazo (site of the Civil War's largest hospital, treating 75,000+ patients), Union Hill, and Fairmont. Each has its own character. The renovation pace has been described as "almost frenetic," and the neighborhood is rapidly becoming one of Richmond's most desirable.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Median Price Range:** \$350K-\$500K (varies significantly by block)
- **Trend:** Strong appreciation, renovation-driven demand
- **Housing:** Historic rowhouses, Victorians, some new construction
- **Rental Market:** Growing, especially renovated units



Photo: Ron Cogswell, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Church Hill continued

HISTORY THAT MATTERS

Church Hill's history isn't just a selling point. It's a responsibility. St. John's Church, Chimborazo Park, and the surrounding historic district are preserved landmarks. When you buy here, you're investing in a neighborhood that takes its heritage seriously.

DINING & NIGHTLIFE

- **Sub Rosa Bakery:** Wood-fired bread, nationally recognized
- **The Roosevelt:** James Beard semifinalist (Leah Branch)
- **Alewife:** Modern seafood, one of RVA's best
- **Alamo BBQ:** Legendary local BBQ joint
- **Chimborazo Park views:** Best sunset spot in the city

WHAT'S HAPPENING NOW

Major renovation activity. Investors and owner-occupants are restoring historic homes block by block. New restaurants and shops opening regularly. The neighborhood maintains a small-town urban atmosphere while being just outside downtown.

SUB-NEIGHBORHOODS

- Chimborazo:** Hilltop with best views, park access, most renovated section
- Union Hill:** More affordable, active renovation, strong community
- Fairmont:** Quieter, emerging, best value within Church Hill

BEST FOR

History lovers, renovation enthusiasts, investors looking for appreciation potential, anyone who wants character and city views at lower prices than the Fan. Church Hill rewards people who can see what a neighborhood is becoming, not just what it is today.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Some blocks are fully renovated; others are still transitioning. Do your homework block by block, not just neighborhood-wide. City tax rate applies. Served by Richmond City Public Schools (research at doe.virginia.gov). Some areas have limited retail within walking distance.

Fitness in the polygon: Three verified gyms inside the Church Hill polygon. CrossFit Prelude and River City Fit (strength + mobility) share an address on East Marshall in Chimborazo. 3S Yoga sits in Union Hill on Jefferson Avenue. For commercial gym access, expect to drive into Shockoe Bottom or the Fan. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Scott's Addition

From forgotten industrial district to Richmond's hottest neighborhood in a decade. Scott's Addition is brewery heaven, urban living, and creative energy compressed into a few walkable blocks.

Named after General Winfield Scott, who inherited this land in 1818, Scott's Addition spent most of the 20th century as a commercial and industrial zone. Factories, warehouses, and auto shops lined the streets. When the railroad industry declined, the neighborhood went quiet.

Then the microbreweries arrived. The Veil, Vasen, Ardent Craft Ales, and others transformed vacant warehouses into taprooms. Restaurants followed. Then apartments. Then condos. Today, Scott's Addition has 2,000+ new residential units and is one of the most walkable, most energetic neighborhoods in Richmond.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Median Price Range:** \$400K-\$550K
- **Housing Type:** Loft conversions, new-build apartments, some townhomes
- **Rental Market:** Strong demand, especially for walkable units near breweries
- **Trend:** Continued development, prices rising with new construction

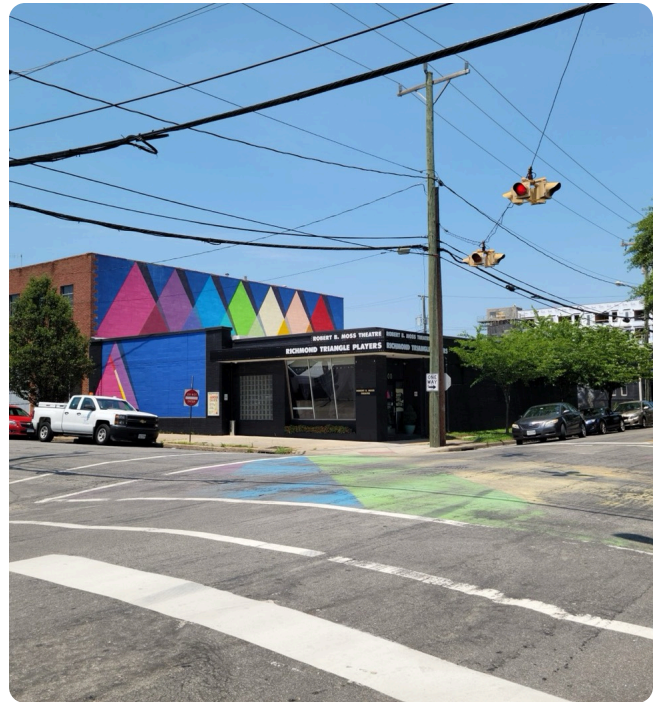


Photo: Eli Christman, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Scott's Addition continued

THE BREWERY & FOOD SCENE

This is Richmond's craft beverage capital. Within a few walkable blocks:

- **The Veil Brewing:** Lines on Thursday afternoons. Worth it.
- **Vasen Brewing:** Funky, creative, farmhouse ales
- **Ardent Craft Ales:** Great beer garden
- **Lunch. | Supper!:** Southern food, arrive early or wait
- **Brenner Pass:** Elevated Alpine dining, Richmond favorite
- **Fat Dragon:** Best modern Chinese on Boulevard
- **Gelati Celesti:** Best gelato in the state
- **Hofgarden:** Rooftop pizza and live music

ENTERTAINMENT

- **Bow Tie Cinemas:** Converted steel factory, only centrally located movie theater
- **River City Roll:** Boutique bowling alley and bar
- **The Circuit Arcade Bar:** Nostalgic arcade games + craft beer

THE INDUSTRIAL HERITAGE

Warehouse-style structures define the aesthetic here. Many buildings are beautifully repurposed: exposed brick, steel beams, high ceilings. Some remain vacant, awaiting their next chapter. The contrast between old and new is part of the appeal.

BEST FOR

Young professionals, beer enthusiasts, creatives, anyone who wants to live in the center of Richmond's social scene. If you want to walk to 8 breweries, a meadery, a cidery, and a distillery without crossing a highway, Scott's Addition is the only answer.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Can be noisy on weekends (brewery crowds). Most housing is new construction or conversions, so you trade historic charm for modern finishes. Limited green space compared to the Fan or Church Hill. Construction is ongoing, which means the neighborhood is still evolving. Parking can be tight on brewery-heavy blocks.

Fitness in the polygon: Six verified gyms inside the polygon, anchored by Crunch Fitness on West Broad and Peak Experiences (climbing) on Overbrook. Boutique density: City Barre on Belleville, Pure Fitness RVA on West Moore, Vintage Boxing Club on Arthur Ashe Boulevard, RVA Performance Training on Hermitage. Strong category mix without leaving the neighborhood. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Jackson Ward

Known as the "Harlem of the South" and "Black Wall Street of America," Jackson Ward is a national historic district with some of the deepest cultural roots in Richmond.

Dating to the late 1700s, Jackson Ward was the center of African American business, entertainment, and culture in the Southeast. Maggie L. Walker, the first Black woman to charter a bank in the United States, lived and worked here. Bill "Bojangles" Robinson grew up on these streets. The Hippodrome Theater hosted Ella Fitzgerald, Duke Ellington, and Billie Holiday.

The construction of I-95/I-64 in the 1950s devastated the neighborhood, displacing 10% of Richmond's Black population and severing the community. But Jackson Ward is writing its next chapter. New investment, preservation efforts, and community-driven development are reconnecting what the highway divided.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Price Range:** \$380K-\$475K
- **Trend:** Values up 11-19.7% year over year
- **Inventory:** Very limited. Homes sell within ~1 month
- **Housing:** Historic rowhouses, modern condos, mixed-income developments
- **Demographics:** Median age 30, 61% with bachelor's degree+



Photo: Morgan Riley, CC BY 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Jackson Ward continued

HISTORIC & CULTURAL LANDMARKS

- **Maggie L. Walker National Historic Site:** Her home, preserved as a museum
- **Black History Museum & Cultural Center of Virginia**
- **Hippodrome Theater:** Restored, hosts events and performances
- **First Fridays Art Walk:** Monthly gallery, food, live music event
- **2nd Street Festival:** Annual celebration of Black heritage and culture

DINING

- **Mama J's Kitchen:** James Beard Award semifinalist, soul food icon
- **GwarBar:** Yes, named after the band. Surprisingly great food.
- Growing roster of international restaurants and cafes

WHAT'S HAPPENING NOW

Major revitalization focused on preserving Black heritage while expanding housing and business opportunities. Gilpin Court transformation underway. New bridges and freeway lids planned to reconnect neighborhoods severed by I-95. Small business hubs emerging. Affordable housing expansion in progress.

THE REVITALIZATION VISION

Jackson Ward's future is being shaped by five priorities: supporting Black education and business, expanding affordable housing, preserving historic character, improving transportation and green space, and reconnecting communities divided by the highway. The 2025 Renaissance Faire brought 75+ artisans and performers, signaling the neighborhood's growing cultural momentum.

BEST FOR

Culture seekers, history enthusiasts, anyone who values community roots and wants to be part of a neighborhood's renaissance. Excellent walkability to VCU, downtown, and public transit. Strong appreciation potential for buyers who understand the trajectory.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Revitalization is real but uneven. Some blocks are fully transformed; others are still early-stage. Income disparity is significant (49% earn under \$45K, 14% earn over \$150K). Construction and highway infrastructure projects will cause disruption over the next several years. Do block-level research, not just neighborhood-level.

Fitness in the polygon: Two verified gyms inside the polygon, both in the City Center stretch on North 3rd Street: Hour Cycle Studio (cycling) and Upstream BJJ (jiu-jitsu). For commercial gyms, expect to drive into the Fan or Scott's Addition. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Manchester

Directly south of the James River from downtown, Manchester is Richmond's most rapidly developing neighborhood. If you want waterfront access, skyline views, and early-adopter energy, this is where to look.

Historically an industrial district nicknamed "Dogtown," Manchester spent decades as a quiet, overlooked area south of the river. That's changed dramatically. New residential developments, restaurants, and cultural venues are transforming the neighborhood at a pace that's drawing both investors and young buyers.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Median Listing Price:** \$415K (up 17.7% YoY)
- **Median Sold Price:** \$360K
- **Some areas reaching:** \$702K for premium waterfront
- **Rental:** \$1,525-\$1,606 for 1BR
- **Walk Score:** 75 (Very Walkable)
- **Population:** ~2,300 (core), median age 34.8

WHAT MAKES MANCHESTER DIFFERENT

Manchester gives you a skyline view of downtown Richmond from your side of the river. Floodwall Park and the James River Park System are at your doorstep. The Manchester Bridge connects you to downtown in minutes. And because the neighborhood is still emerging, you're buying into appreciation potential that established neighborhoods have already captured

FITNESS IN THE POLYGON

One verified gym sits inside the entire Manchester polygon: Body Arc, 131 Richmond Highway. That is the full inventory. If a quick drive to your gym matters, plan a route into Shockoe Bottom or VCU. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

ARTS & CULTURE

- **Richmond Art Expo**
- **Art Works Gallery**
- **Juneteenth at Manchester Dock:** Major annual celebration
- **Richmond Railroad Museum**
- **Monthly Art Walks & Festivals**

PARKS & OUTDOOR

- James River Park System access
- Floodwall Park (river trail, views)
- Ancarrow's Landing (kayak launch)
- Mayo Island (becoming major park by 2026)

BEST FOR

Investors, young buyers, anyone who wants waterfront access and is comfortable with a neighborhood still writing its story. A+ nightlife rating. Growing brewery and restaurant scene.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Limited pharmacy and healthcare access

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Byrd Park & Carytown

Byrd Park

A community hub near downtown where culture, green space, and residential charm converge. Byrd Park sits adjacent to Maymont Estate, giving residents access to 100 acres of gardens, wildlife exhibits, and walking trails without leaving the neighborhood.

QUICK FACTS

- **Median Home Price:** \$457,500
- **Population:** ~1,479 residents
- **Homeowners:** 64% | Renters: 36%
- **Safety:** Safer than 56% of Richmond neighborhoods

ARCHITECTURE

One of the most diverse architectural palettes in the city: early 20th-century rowhouses, Mediterranean Revival, Colonial Revival, Craftsman, Tudor Revival, Beaux-Arts, and lake-view condos. Every block looks different.

EVENTS

- **Arts in the Park:** Nearly 400 artists annually
- **Dogwood Dell Festival of the Arts** (outdoor amphitheater)
- **Jazz at Fountain Lake**
- **Juneteenth celebrations**

BEST FOR

Families who want city living with green space. Park lovers. Culture enthusiasts. People who want Maymont in their backyard and Carytown around the corner.

Carytown

Known as Richmond's "Mile of Style," Carytown is a walkable shopping and dining district that feels like a small town embedded in the city. Boutique shops, coffee spots, and some of Richmond's best restaurants line Cary Street from Thompson to Boulevard.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Can Can Brasserie:** Parisian cafe vibes, incredible French food
- **Carytown Teas:** Tea experts, local institution
- **Lolita's:** Creative Mexican in a pink paradise
- **World of Mirth:** Quirky toy and gift shop
- **Bygones Vintage:** Time-capsule vintage clothing
- **I Love You So Much Bookstore:** Preloved books, full of character

HOW TO EXPLORE

Start at the corner of Cary St and S. Nansemond St and walk east. Every block reveals something new. The Byrd Theatre (1928) anchors the eastern end with \$5 movies in a gilded auditorium.

BEST FOR

Shoppers, foodies, walkable lifestyle enthusiasts. Living near Carytown means you rarely need a car for errands, dining, or entertainment. Popular with young professionals and empty-nesters who want urban convenience with neighborhood charm.

Fitness in the polygon: Four verified gyms inside the

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Shockoe Bottom

One of Richmond's most historically significant neighborhoods, Shockoe Bottom carries both the weight of its past and the energy of its present.

HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Shockoe Bottom traces its roots to 1737, when William Byrd II established Richmond's original commercial district here. For centuries, it served as a hub for commerce and trade, particularly tobacco. But the neighborhood also holds a painful history: it was the second-largest slave trading market in the United States, after New Orleans. Lumpkin's Jail, a notorious slave holding facility, and African American burial grounds are part of this landscape.

In 2014, the National Trust for Historic Preservation named Shockoe Bottom a National Treasure, recognizing both its significance and the need for thoughtful preservation.

TODAY

Post-Civil War, Shockoe Bottom rebuilt and thrived. Today it's home to Richmond's oldest public market (the 17th Street Farmers' Market), a growing nightlife scene, and a mix of historic warehouses converted to lofts and modern condos. The neighborhood bridges Church Hill to the north and the James River to the south.

DINING & NIGHTLIFE

- 17th Street Farmers' Market (one of America's oldest)
- Bottoms Up Pizza (Richmond institution)
- Growing cocktail bar and restaurant scene
- Active nightlife corridor on weekend evenings

BEST FOR

History-conscious buyers who want downtown access. Nightlife enthusiasts. Loft-living seekers. People who want to live where Richmond's story began.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Flood zone considerations (the Bottom sits in a low-lying area near the river). Weekend nightlife noise. Some blocks are more developed than others. The neighborhood's historical complexity means ongoing conversations about development, preservation, and memorialization.

Fitness in the polygon: Two verified gyms inside the polygon: Shockoe Bottom CrossFit on North 18th Street and Square Code Fitness on East Main in Shockoe Slip. Both are walkable from the loft conversions in the historic warehouse blocks. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Fulton & Rocketts Landing

Richmond's East End riverfront, where industrial heritage meets modern waterfront development and direct access to the Virginia Capital Trail.

FULTON

Named after James Alexander Fulton, this ~350-acre neighborhood sits between Rocketts Landing and Church Hill. Post-Civil War, simple one-story homes made it one of Richmond's earliest suburbs. By the early 1900s, bungalows, Cape Cods, and ranches filled the streets, along with restaurants, stores, and streetcar service.

The 1960s-70s brought decline: deteriorating infrastructure, a devastating flood from Hurricane Agnes (1972), and large-scale demolition under a revitalization plan. But Fulton is resurging. Developers and homebuyers are discovering the neighborhood's riverfront potential.

ROCKETTS LANDING

The anchor development: high-end riverfront townhomes, condos, restaurants, and offices along the James River. This is Richmond's most intentional waterfront community, with direct Capital Trail access, river views, and a growing restaurant scene.

FITNESS IN THE POLYGON

Zero Tier A or B gyms inside the Fulton and Rocketts Landing polygon. Closest options: Shockoe Bottom CrossFit and Square Code Fitness (10-12 min drive), plus Gold's Gym East End and Planet Fitness Eastgate just over the Henrico line. Factor the drive in before you make an offer here. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Island Shrimp Co:** Seafood with river and city views
- **Triple Crossing Beer:** Craft brewery, pizza, dog-friendly patio
- **Stone Brewing:** East Coast operations, tours available
- **Virginia Capital Trail:** 52-mile multi-use trail to Williamsburg starts here
- **Richmond BMX:** Public racing track
- **Gillies Creek Disc Golf Course**

BEST FOR

Waterfront living seekers, trail runners and cyclists, people who want modern construction with river views. Rocketts Landing specifically appeals to professionals who want a walkable riverfront community without the noise of downtown.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

Laburnum Park & Northside

Richmond's Northside neighborhoods offer something the Fan and Church Hill can't: larger historic homes on bigger lots at lower prices, with tree-lined boulevard streets that feel like a different era.

LABURNUM PARK

Named after Joseph Bryan's post-Civil War estate, Laburnum Park is a historic Northside neighborhood where the bulk of homes were built between 1919 and 1930. The architecture is stunning: American Foursquare, Colonial Revival, Bungalow, and Tudor Revival homes on unusually large lots with boulevard-style streets and wide tree-lined medians.

Recent years have brought renewed interest from buyers drawn to the larger homes, spacious yards, and proximity to downtown and VCU. Interstate access makes commuting easy, and nearby private schools (Veritas, others) add to the appeal for families.

DINING NEARBY

- **Dot's Back Inn:** Greasy spoon classic, packed outdoor seating
- **Enoteca Sogno:** Italian, excellent wine list
- **Demi's Mediterranean Kitchen:** Greek/Mediterranean
- **Mi Jalisco:** Margaritas and tacos
- **Stir Crazy:** Coffee, tea, food
- **Little House Green Grocery:** Local, organic foods

SIMILAR NEIGHBORHOODS

Northside includes several neighborhoods with comparable character:

Bellevue: Walks to the MacArthur Avenue shops, mostly 1920s bungalows

Ginter Park: Spacious historic homes, Lewis Ginter Botanical Garden nearby

Sherwood Park: Quiet, tree-lined, good value for larger homes

BEST FOR

Buyers who want historic character and space at prices below the Fan and Museum District. Families who want larger yards. Anyone who appreciates boulevard streets, mature trees, and homes with architectural personality. Strong value play within city limits.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Farther from the city's core dining and nightlife districts. Some blocks are well-maintained; others need more investment. City tax rate applies. Northside doesn't get the same buzz as the Fan or Church Hill, which means less foot traffic and fewer walkable restaurants, but also means better prices and less competition.

RICHMOND CITY NEIGHBORHOODS

More City Neighborhoods

Richmond is packed with neighborhoods beyond the headliners. Here are quick profiles of areas worth exploring.

Forest Hill

Median: \$375-475K | Vibe: Forest Hill Park and its Saturday farmers market

A suburban feel within the city, with great parks and James River access. Forest Hill Park hosts a weekly farmers market and features trails, a lake, and picnic areas. Quieter than the Fan or Church Hill but with easy access to both. Popular with families who want city living without the intensity. Served by Richmond City Public Schools.

Fitness: 4 verified gyms in the polygon: Anytime Fitness on Forest Hill Avenue, BOHO Quad Studio (strength), Onward Fitness (strength + conditioning), and MMA Institute on Jahnke Road. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

Families

Park Access

Quieter City Living

Ginter Park

Median: \$350-450K | Vibe: Bigger lots than the Fan, next to Lewis Ginter

Spacious historic homes on tree-lined streets with a relaxed vibe. Close to Lewis Ginter Botanical Garden (one of Richmond's top attractions). Larger lots and lower prices than comparable homes in the Fan. The neighborhood has a strong community identity and active civic association.

Space

Historic Homes

Value

The West End (City)

Median: \$325-425K | Vibe: Easy parking, Willow Lawn two minutes away

The western edge of Richmond City buys you a driveway, a yard, and a ten-minute drive to Carytown, at \$150K-\$250K under Fan pricing. A good option for people who want city benefits without the premium price of core neighborhoods.

Fitness: Zero Tier A or B gyms inside the City West End polygon. The Willow Lawn cluster everyone assumes is in the city (Gold's Gym, Row House, The Hot Yoga Barre at 1601 Willow Lawn Drive) actually sits just over the line in Henrico's Tuckahoe section. Closest in-city options: the Fan and Scott's Addition. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

Convenience

Value

Easy Parking

RICHMOND CITY

The James River Richmond's Greatest Asset

Most cities charge for outdoor experiences this good. Richmond's are free. The James River Park System offers over 20 miles of trails through the heart of the city, and it's unlike anything you'll find in DC, Charlotte, or Raleigh.



Photo: Mobilus In Mobili / CC BY 2.0

20+

MILES OF TRAILS

Free

ADMISSION ALWAYS

52

MILE CAPITAL TRAIL

Class III-IV

RAPIDS DOWNTOWN

James River Access Points

Each access point offers a different experience. Here's where to go and what to expect.

LOCATION	BEST FOR	ADDRESS	HIGHLIGHTS
Belle Isle	Swimming, hiking, biking	344 Tredegar St, 23219	Flat river rocks, mountain biking trails, swimming holes. Most popular spot.
Pony Pasture	Kayaking, tubing, Class III-IV rapids	7310 Riverside Dr, 23225	Ideal for water sports. Go-to spot for adventurers and families.
Maymont Park	Gardens, wildlife, walking	1700 Hampton St, 23220	100-acre estate with gardens, petting zoo, historic mansion. Free.
Capital Trail (start)	Biking, running, scenic	2803 Dock St, 23223	52-mile paved trail to Williamsburg. Upper Shirley Vineyards along the way.
Ancarrow's Landing	Kayak launch, fishing	Manchester side	Best kayak launch point. Views of downtown from the river.
Deep Run Park	Families, dog owners	9900 Ridgefield Pkwy, 23233	Suburban oasis with trails, playgrounds, picnic areas.

ACTIVITIES

- Kayaking & tubing (Class I-II rapids in the city)
- Mountain biking (Belle Isle, North Bank Trail)
- Road cycling (Capital Trail, 52 miles paved)
- Rock hopping & sunbathing
- Fishing (smallmouth bass, catfish)
- Trail running (20+ miles of options)
- Wildlife viewing (herons, eagles, deer)

Miles's take: The James River is the single biggest lifestyle differentiator Richmond has. I've had clients move from DC specifically because of the river access. Where else can you be on Class III-IV rapids within a ten-minute drive of your downtown office? Richmond is the only city in the country with that claim.

RICHMOND CITY

Best Parks in Richmond City

Maymont Park

100-acre Victorian estate with formal gardens, wildlife exhibits (bears, bobcats, eagles), a petting farm, Japanese garden, and the historic Dooley mansion.

Completely free. One of the most beautiful parks on the East Coast. If you have kids, you'll be here weekly.

Bryan Park

Historic Northside park with trails, disc golf, an azalea garden that blooms spectacularly in spring, and a picnic area. Quieter than Belle Isle or Maymont but equally beautiful. A Northside gem.

Belle Isle

The iconic James River park. Flat river rocks for sunbathing, mountain biking trails, wooded walking paths, and swimming holes. Accessed via a pedestrian bridge from Tredegar Street. This is where Richmond goes on a Saturday afternoon.

Pony Pasture

The go-to spot for tubing and kayaking on the James River. Class III-IV rapids for adventurers, calm pools for wading. Popular with families and dogs. Parking fills up on summer weekends, so arrive early.

Forest Hill Park

Trails, a lake, and a weekly farmers market. The South of the James Farmers Market runs here April through November and is one of the best in the state. Great playground and picnic areas for families.

Chimborazo Park

Perched on Church Hill's highest point, this park offers the best sunset views in Richmond. Look west across the city skyline with the James River below. Site of the Civil War's largest hospital. A dog park and walking trails make it a neighborhood anchor.

RICHMOND CITY

Schools in Richmond City

Richmond City and each surrounding county operates its own independent school district. Here's how to research schools in any area you're considering.

RICHMOND CITY PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Richmond City Public Schools serves all neighborhoods within city limits. The district includes neighborhood schools, magnet programs, and specialty centers.

Elementary schools serving city neighborhoods:

Mary Munford, Cary, Fox, Carver, Westover Hills, Southampton, Chimborazo, and others

Middle schools: Binford, Hill, Martin Luther King Jr., Brown, River City

High schools: Open High School (magnet), Huguenot, Wythe, Armstrong, Thomas Jefferson

Research schools before you buy. School assignments are based on home address and change periodically. I always verify school zoning for my clients before making an offer. Visit doe.virginia.gov for performance data and greatschools.org for parent reviews.

PRIVATE SCHOOL OPTIONS

Richmond has a strong private school landscape across all price points:

- Collegiate School
- St. Catherine's / St. Christopher's
- Steward School
- Veritas School
- Richmond Montessori
- Sabot at Stony Point

MILES'S TAKE

Education is one of the most personal decisions in a move. Every family weighs it differently. Public, private, magnet, charter, it does not change my job. I pull the zoning on a specific address before we write an offer. The right home in the wrong school zone is a problem I prevent, not one I fix afterward.

School information in this guide directs readers to independent third-party sources for informational purposes only. MAMS LLC does not rate, rank, or endorse any school or school district. School assignments and performance data change. Verify directly with the school division. Equal Housing Opportunity.

RICHMOND CITY

City Neighborhood Comparison

NEIGHBORHOOD	MEDIAN PRICE	VIBE	WALK SCORE	BEST FOR
The Fan	\$650K	Monument Ave rowhouses, walkable	90+	Young pros, couples, walkability
Museum District	\$550-650K	Quieter Fan, near VMFA	85	Culture lovers, professionals
Church Hill	\$350-550K	Historic, revitalizing, views	70	History lovers, investors
Scott's Addition	\$400-550K	Brewery capital, industrial-chic	80	Young pros, beer enthusiasts
Jackson Ward	\$380-475K	Cultural, revitalizing, arts	85	Culture seekers, community
Manchester	\$360-415K	Waterfront, developing, views	75	Investors, waterfront lifestyle
Byrd Park	\$457K	Green, family-friendly, events	80	Families, park lovers
Carytown area	\$475-600K	Shopping, dining, walkable	90	Foodies, shoppers
Shockoe Bottom	\$325-425K	Historic, nightlife, downtown	85	Downtown access, nightlife
Fulton/Rocketts	\$350-550K	Waterfront, trails, emerging	55	Waterfront, trail access
Laburnum Park	\$300-400K	Spacious, historic, tree-lined	50	Space seekers, value
Forest Hill	\$375-475K	Suburban feel, parks	60	Families, park access
Ginter Park	\$350-450K	Spacious, relaxed, historic	55	Space, garden lovers

All neighborhoods within Richmond City limits share the \$1.20/\$100 property tax rate. Prices reflect 2025-2026 market data and vary by block. Walk Scores approximate based on neighborhood center.

Want block-level detail on any neighborhood?

Name the neighborhood and I'll walk you through the exact streets, pricing trends, and upcoming

PART 3

The Suburbs

More space, lower taxes, independent school districts.
Richmond's suburbs aren't a compromise. For most
families, they're the move.



Tarrington, Chesterfield County. Photo: Packer1028, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons

PART 3: THE SUBURBS

Why the Suburbs Win for Most Families

Richmond's suburbs aren't generic sprawl. Each county has its own identity, school system, tax rate, and lifestyle. The right suburb depends on what you're optimizing for: schools, commute, space, or price.

Three counties surround Richmond City, and each operates independently with its own government, school system, and tax structure. This matters. A \$500K home in Henrico County costs \$4,150 in annual property taxes. That same home in Richmond City costs \$6,000. Over a 10-year hold, that's \$18,500 in savings. Each county also operates its own independent school district.

For demographic data including population, income, age, and diversity statistics for any suburban area, visit data.census.gov.

\$0.81

HANOVER TAX RATE

\$0.83

HENRICO TAX RATE

\$0.89

CHESTERFIELD TAX RATE

\$1.20

RICHMOND CITY

Suburban Living Highlights

- Three independent school districts (Hanover, Henrico, Chesterfield) -- research at doe.virginia.gov
- Lower property tax rates across all three counties
- Newer construction with modern floor plans and amenities
- More square footage per dollar than the city
- Master-planned communities with pools, trails, and clubhouses
- 15-30 minute commute to downtown via highways

What to Know

- **Car-dependent:** You'll need a vehicle. Public transit is limited outside the city.
- **Less walkable:** Most suburbs are designed around driving, not walking.
- **Newer = less character:** If you want 100-year-old rowhouses, stay in the city.
- **HOAs are common:** Master-planned communities come with rules and monthly fees.
- **Growth = construction:** Some areas have ongoing development, which means traffic and noise during build-out.

Miles's take: The suburbs deserve serious consideration. Independent school districts, lower taxes

Suburban Comparison: Every Area Side by Side

AREA	COUNTY	MEDIAN PRICE	TAX RATE	SCHOOL DISTRICT	COMMUTE	BEST FOR
Short Pump	Henrico	\$510K+	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	20 min	Shopping, dining, amenities
Glen Allen	Henrico	\$475-575K	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	18 min	Newer homes, families
Wyndham	Henrico	\$550-750K	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	22 min	Golf, executive homes
River Road	Henrico	\$700K-1.2M	\$0.83	Henrico County PS	15 min	Estates, privacy, river
Midlothian	Chesterfield	\$420-500K	\$0.89	Chesterfield County PS	20 min	Value, families, parks
Moseley	Chesterfield	\$450-550K	\$0.89	Chesterfield County PS	30 min	Master-planned, new builds
Brandermill	Chesterfield	\$375-475K	\$0.89	Chesterfield County PS	22 min	Lake living, established
Mechanicsville	Hanover	\$375-450K	\$0.81	Hanover County PS	25 min	Affordability, space
Ashland	Hanover	\$425-500K	\$0.81	Hanover County PS	30 min	Small-town charm, walkable
Goochland	Goochland	\$500K+	\$0.53	Goochland County PS	35 min	Land, horses, privacy
Powhatan	Powhatan	\$375-500K	\$0.78	Powhatan County PS	40 min	Rural, acreage, value

Tax rates shown per \$100 of assessed value. Commute times to downtown Richmond during non-peak hours. Prices reflect current market data and vary by subdivision. For school performance data, visit [doe.virginia.gov](#) and [greatschools.org](#).

Want a custom suburb comparison?

I'll build a side-by-side analysis based on your priorities: schools, commute, budget, and lifestyle.

HENRICO COUNTY WEST END

Short Pump & Glen Allen

Richmond's premier suburban corridor. If you want Short Pump Town Center at the end of your street, every restaurant and amenity within 10 minutes, and access to Henrico County Public Schools, Short Pump and Glen Allen deliver.

The Henrico County west end stretches along the I-64 and Broad Street corridors west of downtown Richmond. Short Pump is the commercial and retail hub. Glen Allen extends north toward I-295. Together, they're one of the strongest suburban corridors in Greater Richmond.

This is where most of Richmond's corporate employers have satellite offices. Capital One, CarMax, Markel, and dozens of tech firms have operations along the West Broad corridor. For remote workers, it means coffee shops and coworking spaces are everywhere, and the fiber internet infrastructure is excellent.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Short Pump Median:** ~\$510K (varies widely by subdivision)
- **Glen Allen Median:** \$475-575K
- **Price per Sq Ft:** \$200-\$275
- **Property Tax:** \$0.83 per \$100 assessed value
- **Trend:** Steady appreciation, high demand from relocators
- **Inventory:** Competitive. Desirable



Photo: Ser Amantio di Nicolao, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Key Neighborhoods Short Pump & Glen Allen

Wyndham

Short Pump / Glen Allen | \$550K-750K

The gold standard for Henrico County suburban living. Centered around the Dominion Club golf course, Wyndham features executive homes on generous lots, mature landscaping, and a strong community identity. Multiple pools, tennis, and a walkable neighborhood center. Served by Henrico County Public Schools.

Golf Community

Executive Homes

Established

River Road Corridor

Henrico (Near West End) | \$700K-1.2M+

Richmond's quiet luxury. Large lots, mature trees, and stately homes along the James River. No master-planned feel here. This is old Richmond money meets modern renovation. River Road is technically Henrico County, which means lower taxes than the city, but you're only 15 minutes from downtown. Private schools (Collegiate, St. Catherine's, St. Christopher's) are minutes away.

Luxury

Estates

River Access

Twin Hickory

Glen Allen | \$475K-650K

One of Henrico's most popular family neighborhoods. Served by Henrico County Public Schools (including Twin Hickory Elementary), community pools, walking trails, and a mix of home styles from townhouses to single-family. Strong neighborhood identity and active HOA with events throughout the year.

Henrico Schools

Family-Focused

Trails

Wellesley

Short Pump | \$525K-700K

Upscale community near Short Pump Town Center. Newer construction with modern floor plans, community pool and clubhouse, and easy access to shopping and dining. Popular with dual-income families who want convenience and quality without the million-dollar price tag.

Newer Builds

Convenience

Amenities

West Broad Village

Glen Allen | \$400K-600K

A walkable mixed-use community that's as close to "urban suburban" as you'll find. Townhomes, condos, and single-family homes built around a central retail village with restaurants, shops, a movie theater, and a Whole Foods. Popular with young

Foxhall

Short Pump | \$450K-600K

Established Short Pump neighborhood with a strong community feel. Ranch-style and colonial homes on half-acre+ lots. Mature trees, quieter streets, and solid school zoning. Great for buyers who want Short Pump location without the master-planned HOA structure.

Schools Henrico County West End

Henrico County Public Schools serves the entire Short Pump and Glen Allen area. For performance data on any school listed below, visit doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org.

ELEMENTARY & MIDDLE SCHOOLS

- Twin Hickory Elementary
- Shady Grove Elementary
- Deep Run Elementary
- Pocahontas Middle
- Short Pump Middle

HIGH SCHOOLS

- Deep Run High School - IB program available
- Glen Allen High School - Diverse student body
- Godwin High School - Near West End, established programs

SPECIALTY PROGRAMS

- Henrico Center for the Arts - Magnet program at Hermitage High
- International Baccalaureate - Available at Deep Run HS
- Specialty Centers - Advanced studies across multiple HS

PRIVATE SCHOOL OPTIONS

- Collegiate School - K-12, River Road (\$30K+/yr)
- St. Catherine's School - All-girls, River Road
- St. Christopher's School - All-boys, River Road
- Trinity Episcopal School - PreK-8, Near West End
- Steward School - K-12, West End

Miles's take: School zoning is one of the first conversations I have with relocating families. I always verify school zoning before my clients make an offer, because two houses on the same street can feed into different schools. Visit greatschools.org and doe.virginia.gov to research Henrico County schools. I'll help you narrow down which zones align with the neighborhoods you're considering.

SCHOOL ZONING MATTERS

In Henrico County, school assignments are based on your home address. Two houses on the same street can feed into different schools. I always verify school zoning before my clients make an offer. Never assume.

Shopping & Dining Short Pump & Glen Allen

SHOPPING

Short Pump is Richmond's retail epicenter. If you can't find it here, you probably can't find it in Richmond.

- **Short Pump Town Center** - Open-air luxury mall: Nordstrom, Apple, Pottery Barn, Lululemon, 100+ stores
- **West Broad Village** - Walkable mixed-use: Whole Foods, REI, restaurants, movie theater
- **The Shoppes at Wellesley** - Boutique retail near Short Pump Town Center
- **The Shoppes at Westgate** - Home goods, specialty retail
- **Costco, Target, Trader Joe's** - All within the Short Pump corridor

GROCERIES

- Whole Foods (West Broad Village)
- Wegmans (Short Pump)
- Publix (multiple locations)
- Trader Joe's (Short Pump)
- Lidl (Glen Allen)
- H Mart (Asian grocery, Broad St)

DINING HIGHLIGHTS

- **Peter Chang's** - Nationally acclaimed Sichuan (Short Pump)
- **Kabana Rooftop** - Upscale Indian fusion, rooftop bar
- **Kona Grill** - Sushi and American, Town Center
- **Liberty Public House** - Gastropub, local favorite
- **Bonefish Grill** - Seafood, consistent quality
- **Tazza Kitchen** - Farm-to-table, wood-fired
- **The Boathouse** - Waterfront seafood (Sunday River)
- **Cava, Chipotle, Panera** - Fast-casual options everywhere

COFFEE & REMOTE WORK

- **Ironclad Coffee** - Best local roaster, West Broad Village
- **Brewed** - Cozy, popular with remote workers
- **Panera Bread** - Multiple locations with free WiFi
- **WeWork** - Coworking space opening in West Broad area
- **Library** - Henrico's Tuckahoe and Twin Hickory branches are excellent

Parks & Lifestyle Short Pump & Glen Allen

PARKS & RECREATION

- **Deep Run Park** - 200+ acres: playgrounds, trails, sports fields, dog park. Henrico's flagship park.
- **Short Pump Park** - 38 acres: splash pad, playground, walking trails, pavilions
- **Crump Park** - Mountain bike trails, hiking, and creek access
- **RF&P Park** - Sports complex with baseball, soccer, basketball
- **Three Lakes Park** - Nature center, fishing, hiking, seasonal events
- **Henrico County Recreation** - Pools, sports leagues, camps for all ages

ENTERTAINMENT

- **TopGolf** - Entertainment complex near Short Pump
- **Drive Shack** - Golf entertainment, Glen Allen
- **AMC & Cinemark** - Multiple movie theaters
- **Kings Dominion** - 20 minutes north (season passes are a local staple)
- **Richmond Raceway** - NASCAR events, concerts



Photo: Chrisodva, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons

REMOTE WORKER APPEAL

Short Pump and Glen Allen have quietly become one of Richmond's best remote work corridors. Fiber internet is standard in most neighborhoods. Coffee shops, libraries, and coworking spaces are plentiful. And unlike the city, you can knock out a full workday and still be at your kid's 3pm soccer game in 5 minutes. The combination of excellent internet, affordable housing, a modest 5.75% top state income tax rate, and proximity to an international airport makes this area quietly compelling for remote professionals relocating from higher-cost metros.

The Commute Reality: Short Pump to downtown Richmond is 20 minutes off-peak via I-64. During rush hour (7:30-9am, 4:30-6:30pm), add 10-15 minutes. Most residents consider this reasonable, especially coming from DC, Northern Virginia, or any major metro. I-288 connects south to Midlothian and Chesterfield without touching I-64.

Short Pump & Glen Allen summary

BEST FOR

Families with school-age children who want access to Henrico County Public Schools. Dual-income households who want restaurants, shopping, and amenities within 10 minutes. Remote workers who need reliable infrastructure and don't want to pay city prices. Relocators from Northern Virginia, DC, Charlotte, or Raleigh who want the same suburban quality at 30-40% less.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Car-dependent. You're driving everywhere. Broad Street traffic during peak hours can test your patience. Some areas feel generic: strip malls, chain restaurants, and master-planned sameness. If you want walkability, character, or nightlife, Short Pump isn't your neighborhood. The further west you go, the newer and more cookie-cutter it gets. HOA fees range from \$100-\$400/month in some communities.

Fitness in the polygon: 38 verified gyms across Henrico's western half, the densest county inventory in the metro. Short Pump alone holds 11. The Tuckahoe / Willow Lawn cluster (Gold's, Row House, The Hot Yoga Barre at 1601 Willow Lawn Drive) sits inside this polygon, not the city. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

A \$500K home here	\$4,150/yr property tax
Same home in the city	\$6,000/yr property tax

Next: Midlothian & Moseley, where your dollar goes even further.



Photo: Amanda Smith, Unsplash License

Miles's take: I'll be straight with you. Short Pump's strength is convenience. The amenities are unmatched in the region, the homes are well-built, and Henrico County Public Schools serves the area. Is it exciting? Not really. It's not the Fan or Church Hill. But when your priority is a comfortable daily life with everything within 10 minutes, Short Pump delivers exactly what it promises. No surprises. That's the appeal.

Pro Tip: Subdivision Shopping In Short Pump and Glen Allen, the subdivision matters more than the zip code. Two neighborhoods a mile apart can differ by \$150K in median price, different school

CHESTERFIELD COUNTY

Midlothian & Moseley

Richmond's best value proposition. Midlothian and Moseley deliver strong schools, newer homes, and outdoor access at prices that consistently undercut Short Pump by 15-25%.

Chesterfield County's northwest corridor has exploded over the past decade. Midlothian, once a quiet mining town (yes, coal was mined here), is now one of the fastest-growing communities in Virginia. Moseley, further southwest along Route 288, is where the newest master-planned developments are concentrated. Together they offer families the space, schools, and amenities they're looking for at a price point that leaves room to breathe.

The Powhite Parkway (Route 76) connects Midlothian to downtown Richmond in 20 minutes. Route 288 loops west and connects to Short Pump without touching city traffic. For commuters heading to downtown, Midlothian Turnpike provides a secondary route.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Midlothian Median:** \$420-500K
- **Moseley Median:** \$450-550K
- **Price per Sq Ft:** \$175-\$240
- **Property Tax:** \$0.89 per \$100 assessed value
- **Trend:** Strong new construction driving growth
- **New Construction:** Abundant, especially in



Photo: Amanda Smith, Unsplash License

Key Neighborhoods Midlothian & Moseley

Brandermill

Midlothian | \$375K-475K

One of Virginia's original master-planned communities, built around Swift Creek Reservoir. 2,800 acres with miles of trails, a private lake for boating and fishing, community pools, tennis courts, and a golf course. Original also means older. You are buying full-grown trees and, on most of these homes, somebody else's kitchen. Stock runs from townhouses to lakefront estates.

Lake Living

Trails

Established

Hallsley

Moseley | \$550K-800K

Chesterfield's premier new community. Award-winning master plan with a resort-style pool complex, miles of trails, community gardens, and a village center. Homes are newer with modern floor plans, energy-efficient construction, and thoughtful architecture that avoids the cookie-cutter feel. Cosby High School feeder zone.

Premier

New Construction

Resort Amenities

Woodlake

Midlothian | \$350K-475K

Another lakefront master-planned community, similar to Brandermill but with a different energy. Built around a 135-acre lake with a private beach, two pools, fitness center, and 17 miles of paved trails. More affordable entry point for lakefront living. Active community association with year-round events.

Lakefront

Affordable

Active Community

Magnolia Green

Moseley | \$400K-600K

Large-scale community with a golf course, resort pool, trails, and a community center. Mix of builders offering different styles and price points. Strong schools and a growing commercial presence along Route 288. One of the more affordable new-construction options in the Moseley corridor.

Golf Course

Multiple Builders

Growing

Salisbury

Midlothian | \$450K-600K

Upscale Midlothian neighborhood with a country club at its center. Expect to pay roughly \$75K-\$125K over Brandermill for the lot size and the address. Close to Midlothian Turnpike shopping and dining. Served by Chesterfield County Public

FoxCreek

Moseley | \$425K-575K

Family-oriented community with an 18-hole golf course, resort-style pool, tennis, and walking trails. Well-maintained common areas and a strong HOA. Established enough to have mature landscaping but new enough to have modern home designs.

Schools Chesterfield County

Chesterfield County Public Schools serves the Midlothian and Moseley areas. For performance data on any school listed below, visit doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org.

HIGH SCHOOLS

- **Cosby High School** - Moseley area. STEM programs, athletics, arts.
- **Midlothian High School** - Central Midlothian. Established community identity.
- **Clover Hill High School** - Brandermill/Woodlake feeder. Performing arts and IB program.
- **Manchester High School** - Growing reputation, strong athletics

ELEMENTARY & MIDDLE SCHOOLS

- **Bettie Weaver Elementary** - Midlothian area
- **Woolridge Elementary** - Midlothian
- **Tomahawk Creek Middle** - Midlothian/Moseley feeder
- **Swift Creek Middle** - Brandermill feeder

SPECIALTY PROGRAMS

- **Appomattox Regional Governor's School** - Gifted STEM magnet (application required)
- **Chesterfield Technical Center** - Career and technical education
- **IB Programme** - Available at Clover Hill HS
- **Specialty Centers** - Advanced academics at multiple high schools

Miles's take: Chesterfield County Public Schools serves the entire Midlothian and Moseley corridor. The trick with school zoning here is knowing which subdivisions feed into which schools. Two neighborhoods a mile apart can have completely different feeder patterns. That's where I come in. I always verify school zoning before my clients make an offer. Visit doe.virginia.gov for performance data.

COSBY VS. THE REST

Cosby High School's zone covers most of the Moseley corridor, including Hallsley, Magnolia Green, and FoxCreek. If Cosby is a priority, verify the school zone before you fall in love with a house. Midlothian High's zone covers central Midlothian, and Clover Hill covers Brandermill/Woodlake.

Shopping & Dining Midlothian & Moseley

SHOPPING

- **Westchester Commons** - Open-air shopping center: Target, Publix, restaurants, and specialty stores. Moseley's commercial hub.
- **Midlothian Village** - Mix of local boutiques and chain retail along Midlothian Turnpike
- **Chesterfield Towne Center** - Traditional mall with major anchors (currently redeveloping)
- **Winterfield Crossing** - Newer retail center with grocery, dining, and services
- **Kroger, Publix, Food Lion** - Multiple grocery options throughout

DINING HIGHLIGHTS

- **Sedona Taphouse** - Gastropub, extensive menu, Midlothian
- **Latitude Seafood Co.** - Fresh seafood, local favorite
- **Shagbark** - Farm-to-table fine dining (Midlothian Turnpike)
- **The Boathouse at Sunday Park** - Waterfront dining on Swift Creek Reservoir
- **Brio Italian** - Upscale Italian, Stony Point area
- **Mission BBQ** - Military-themed BBQ, community gathering spot
- **La Milpa** - Authentic Mexican, beloved local spot
- **Crust Pizza** - Local chain, great thin crust

COFFEE & BRUNCH

- **Perch** - Local coffee shop, cozy, great for remote work
- **Sugar & Twine** - Bakery and coffee, Midlothian location
- **Brewed** - Local roaster, multiple Chesterfield locations
- **First Watch** - Daytime cafe, popular brunch spot



Photo: Virginia State Parks, CC BY 2.0

GROWING FAST

The Moseley/Route 288 corridor adds new restaurants and retail monthly. Westchester Commons continues expanding. What felt "far out" five years ago now has everything you need within 10 minutes. The commercial growth follows the rooftops, and Chesterfield is adding rooftops faster than any county in the region.

Parks & Outdoor Life Midlothian & Moseley

This is where Midlothian genuinely stands out. Pocahontas State Park alone would make this area worth considering. Add in Midlothian Mines Park, Swift Creek Reservoir, and the community trail systems, and you've got outdoor access that rivals anything in the city.

Pocahontas State Park

7,919 acres of forests, lakes, and trails. One of Virginia's best state parks, and it's in your backyard. Mountain biking trails (nationally recognized), hiking, fishing, swimming pool, camping, and an aquatic center. Annual pass: \$45. For families, this is an enormous asset that doesn't show up on Zillow.

7,919 Acres

MTB Trails

Swimming



Photo: Virginia State Parks, CC BY 2.0

Midlothian Mines Park

Historic coal mining site turned 42-acre park. Walking trails past original mine shafts and mining artifacts. Playground, pavilions, and fishing. Most people who move to Chesterfield never hear about it. Managed by Chesterfield County Parks.

Historic

42 Acres

Trails

Swift Creek Reservoir

A 1,700-acre reservoir shared by Brandermill and Woodlake communities. Kayaking, canoeing, fishing (bass, catfish, crappie), and paddleboarding. Non-motorized boats only, which keeps it peaceful. Surrounded by trails and green space. If lake living is your thing but you don't want to leave the metro area, this is your spot.

MORE PARKS & TRAILS

- **Robious Landing Park** - James River access, canoe/kayak launch, trails
- **Rockwood Park** - Nature center, trails, community events
- **Falling Creek Ironworks Park** - Historic site, walking trails
- **Brandermill Trail System** - 17+ miles within

Miles's take: Pocahontas State Park is genuinely one of the best state parks on the East Coast, and it's 15 minutes from most Midlothian neighborhoods. My clients who are into mountain biking, hiking, or just want their kids outside on weekends always end up surprised by how much outdoor access Midlothian offers. It's not just subdivisions and strip malls. There's real nature here.

The Value Play Why Midlothian Wins on Math

When I sit down with relocating buyers and run the numbers, Midlothian frequently offers the best combination of quality and affordability in the Richmond metro.

Short Pump (Henrico)

\$510K

2,800 sq ft | \$0.83 tax | Henrico Co. Schools
Annual tax: \$4,233 | HOA: ~\$200/mo

Midlothian (Chesterfield)

\$460K

2,800 sq ft | \$0.89 tax | Chesterfield Co. Schools
Annual tax: \$4,094 | HOA: ~\$125/mo

The Fan (City)

\$650K

1,800 sq ft | \$1.20 tax | Richmond City Schools
Annual tax: \$7,800 | HOA: none

Moseley (Chesterfield)

\$500K

3,200 sq ft | \$0.89 tax | Chesterfield Co. Schools
Annual tax: \$4,450 | HOA: ~\$150/mo

The bottom line: In Midlothian/Moseley, you get more house, more land, and newer construction than either Short Pump or the city. Each area is served by its own independent school district (research at doe.virginia.gov). And the \$150K-\$240K in purchase price savings means lower monthly payments, lower taxes, and more financial flexibility.

WHY MIDLOTHIAN OVER SHORT PUMP?

- 15-25% lower home prices for similar square footage
- Newer construction (many homes built 2015-present)
- Better outdoor access (Pocahontas, Swift Creek Reservoir)
- Less traffic congestion than the Broad Street corridor
- Growing restaurant and retail scene

WHY SHORT PUMP OVER MIDLOTHIAN?

- Henrico County Public Schools district
- More established retail and dining options
- Shorter commute to many employers
- Higher resale demand and liquidity
- More mature neighborhoods with character

Midlothian & Moseley summary

BEST FOR

Families who want new construction, access to Chesterfield County schools, and outdoor access without paying Short Pump prices. Buyers relocating from higher-cost markets who want maximum space for their budget. Outdoor enthusiasts who want Pocahontas State Park in their backyard. First-time homebuyers looking for an entry point into a quality suburb with appreciation potential.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

Moseley is still building out. Some areas have ongoing construction, which means traffic, noise, and a "not finished yet" feel. The dining and retail scene, while growing, doesn't match Short Pump yet. Commute to downtown can be 25-30+ minutes during peak hours via Powhite. HOA rules in master-planned communities can be strict. And if walkability matters at all to you, this isn't the area.

Fitness in the polygon: The Midlothian Corridor holds 16 verified gyms, the densest single-corridor count in the metro (American Family Fitness, acac, Crunch, Gold's, Orangetheory, Peak Experiences climbing, plus 10 more). Chesterfield County's total reaches 29 once Chester, Woodlake, and Meadowbrook are added. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

NEW CONSTRUCTION TIPS

If you're buying new construction in Moseley, use a buyer's agent (that's me). Builder contracts are written by the builder's



Swift Creek Reservoir, the lake Brandermill and Woodlake are built around. Photo: Packer1028, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons

Miles's take: Midlothian flies under the radar, and that's part of the appeal. It's not the flashiest address, but dollar for dollar, you get a lot of house out here. I've had clients tell me they almost didn't look at Midlothian because they'd never heard of it. Then they saw Hallsley or Brandermill and realized they could get significantly more home for the money. It's worth the visit.

Next: Mechanicsville & Hanover County, where lower taxes meet more space.

HANOVER COUNTY

Mechanicsville & Hanover

The lowest tax rate of the big three counties, more space per dollar, and home prices that start well below Short Pump. Hanover County deserves your attention.

Hanover County sits northeast of Richmond, anchored by Mechanicsville (the closest suburb to downtown) and Ashland (a college town with the railroad running down the middle of it). This is where Richmond's suburban character shifts from "master-planned development" to something more rural, more spread out, and more affordable.

Hanover County Public Schools is an independent district serving the entire county. Research their schools at doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org to see how they fit your family's priorities.

REAL ESTATE SNAPSHOT

- **Mechanicsville Median:** \$375-450K
- **Ashland Median:** \$425-500K
- **Price per Sq Ft:** \$160-\$220
- **Property Tax:** \$0.81 per \$100 assessed value
- **Trend:** Steady appreciation, growing demand from relocators
- **Lot Sizes:** Larger than Henrico/Chesterfield, some 1-5+ acre parcels



Fieldshire, Hanover County. Photo: Packer1028, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons

Key Areas Mechanicsville & Hanover

Mechanicsville (Central)

Hanover County | \$350K-425K

The most accessible part of Hanover, just 15-20 minutes from downtown Richmond via Route 360 or I-295. A mix of established neighborhoods, newer subdivisions, and rural pockets. Rutland is the primary commercial corridor with grocery, dining, and retail. Atlee Station area has newer development with modern homes and community amenities.

Closest to City

Value

Mixed Character

Ashland

Northern Hanover | \$350K-450K

Home to Randolph-Macon College, Ashland has a walkable downtown with independent shops, restaurants, and Center of the Universe Brewing. The train literally runs through the middle of town (the town was built around the railroad). Unique small-town identity that's distinctly different from the rest of suburban Richmond.

Walkable Downtown

College Town

Character

Atlee / Elmont

Mechanicsville | \$375K-500K

The newer-development corridor along Route 301 north. Atlee Station, Elmont Estates, and surrounding subdivisions offer modern homes with neighborhood amenities. Feeds into Atlee High School, one of Hanover's strongest. Growing retail presence along the Route 301 corridor.

Newer Homes

Atlee HS Zone

Growing

Beaverdam / Northern Hanover

Northern Hanover | \$300K-400K

True rural living within commuting distance. Larger acreage parcels, horse properties, and agricultural character. Lower prices and more privacy. Best for buyers who want land and don't mind a 30-40 minute commute. Kings Dominion is nearby.

Rural

Acreage

Horses

Cold Harbor / Studley

Eastern Hanover | \$325K-400K

More rural character with larger lots and lower prices. Civil War battlefield sites (Cold Harbor National Battlefield) add historical significance. Less commercial development means more driving for errands, but the tradeoff is space, quiet, and affordability that's hard to match anywhere in the metro.

Kings Dominion: Virginia's premier theme park is in Doswell, northern Hanover County. Season passes are a family staple (\$99-\$150/person). If you have kids under 14, proximity to Kings Dominion is a legitimate lifestyle factor that Hanover delivers.

Schools Hanover County

Hanover County Public Schools serves the Mechanicsville and Ashland areas. For performance data on any school listed below, visit doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org.

HIGH SCHOOLS

- **Atlee High School** - Mechanicsville area. Growing enrollment, newer facilities.
- **Hanover High School** - Near Ashland. Historic campus.
- **Mechanicsville High School** - Community ties, athletics tradition.
- **Patrick Henry High School** - Eastern Hanover. Smaller, community-oriented.

HANOVER COUNTY PUBLIC SCHOOLS

- Smaller district serving the entire county
- Research performance data at doe.virginia.gov
- Parent reviews and community feedback at greatschools.org
- School assignments based on home address
- Fewer enrollment capacity pressures than larger neighboring districts

ELEMENTARY & MIDDLE SCHOOLS

- **Mechanicsville Elementary**
- **Pole Green Elementary** - Atlee feeder
- **Stonewall Jackson Middle**
- **Oak Knoll Middle** - Mechanicsville

Miles's take: Here's the math: \$0.81 tax rate and a \$440K median home price. Over 10 years in a \$400K home, that's \$15,600 in tax savings versus Richmond City. Hanover County Public Schools is an independent district -- research their schools at doe.virginia.gov and greatschools.org to see if it fits your family.

THE HANOVER SCHOOL DECISION

School zone boundaries affect home values. In Hanover, the Atlee HS zone typically commands a \$25-50K price premium over the Mechanicsville HS zone. I can show you comparable homes in both zones and let the data help you decide. Research both schools at doe.virginia.gov.

Lifestyle & Character Mechanicsville & Ashland

DINING & LOCAL FAVORITES

- **Center of the Universe Brewing** - Ashland's anchor. Great beer, food trucks, live music.
- **Hops Kitchen** - Gastropub in Mechanicsville, strong menu
- **Iron Horse Restaurant** - Ashland's upscale dining, train-watching patio
- **Ashland Coffee & Tea** - Live music venue, coffee shop, community hub
- **Homemades by Suzanne** - Iconic Ashland bakery and cafe
- **Mechanicsville Local** - Growing restaurant scene along the Rutland corridor
- **The Camel, Ginger Thai, El Cerro** - Diverse dining options expanding

SHOPPING & SERVICES

- **Rutland Commons** - Mechanicsville's main retail hub: Kroger, Target, restaurants
- **Atlee Station** - Newer retail and grocery options
- **Downtown Ashland** - Independent shops, boutiques, antiques
- **Virginia Center Commons area** - Big box retail along I-95



Photo: DanTD, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Photo: Wikimedia Commons / CC BY-SA 4.0

THE ASHLAND EXPERIENCE

Ashland calls itself the "Center of the Universe" (the brewery's name is literal). It's one of the only walkable downtowns in suburban Richmond. Train tracks run through the main street, and Amtrak stops here. Randolph-Macon College brings cultural events, lectures, and a youthful energy. First Fridays feature art walks, live music, and food vendors. If you want a small-town feel with easy highway access (I-95 is right there), Ashland is unique in the metro.

OUTDOOR ACCESS

- **Pole Green Park** - Mechanicsville's flagship park: trails, sports, playgrounds
- **Poor Farm Park** - 174 acres, nature trails, disc golf
- **Hanover Wayside Park** - River access, picnic areas
- **Cold Harbor Battlefield** - National Park Service site, walking trails

Mechanicsville & Hanover summary

BEST FOR

Families who want larger lots and more breathing room without going fully rural. Anyone relocating from a higher-cost market who wants to maximize square footage per dollar. Buyers drawn to Hanover County Public Schools (research at [doe.virginia.gov](#)). Small-town enthusiasts who'd love Ashland's walkable downtown charm.

HONEST TRADEOFFS

The commute is real. Mechanicsville to downtown is 20-30 minutes, and Ashland is 30-40 minutes. Less dining variety than Short Pump or Midlothian (improving, but still limited). Fewer master-planned community amenities like pools and clubhouses. Some areas feel genuinely rural, which is a pro or con depending on your perspective. Less racial and cultural diversity than other parts of the metro.

Miles's take: Hanover doesn't have the name recognition of Short Pump or the flashy new communities of Moseley. What it has is the lowest taxes of any major county, more space per dollar, and a quieter pace of life. If those are your priorities, Hanover deserves a hard look. Research Hanover County Public Schools at [doe.virginia.gov](#) to see if it's right for your family.

The Hanover vs. Henrico Decision Henrico (Short Pump) offers more dining, shopping, and a shorter commute. Hanover offers lower taxes and more space. Both are strong options with independent school districts. The right answer depends entirely on your priorities. I'll help you weigh the tradeoffs.

Fitness in the polygon: 18 verified gyms across Hanover, 15 of them in Mechanicsville. Anchors: American Family Fitness, Gold's Gym, Planet Fitness, Atlee Station YMCA, Burn Boot Camp, SoGo CrossFit, bOa BJJ. Source: Richmond gyms reference, 2026-04-28.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

\$400K home in Hanover	\$3,240/yr tax
\$400K home in Henrico	\$3,320/yr tax
\$400K home in City	\$4,800/yr tax
10-year savings vs City	\$15,600

Next: Exploring further out for land, privacy, and the lowest taxes in the region.

BEYOND THE INNER SUBURBS

Exploring Further Out

If you want land, privacy, horses, or the lowest tax bill in the metro, Richmond's outer ring delivers. These areas trade convenience for space and character.

Goochland County

West of Richmond | \$500K+ | Tax: \$0.53/100

Richmond's rural luxury belt. Rolling hills, horse farms, and estate-sized lots on the western edge of the metro. Goochland has the lowest property tax rate in Greater Richmond at \$0.53 per \$100. Served by Goochland County Public Schools (research at [doe.virginia.gov](#)). The River Road corridor extends into Goochland, where properties sit on 5-25+ acre parcels. This is where Richmond's old money meets new remote-work flexibility.

Lowest Taxes

Estate Lots

Horse Country

Southern Chesterfield

South of Midlothian | \$325K-425K | Tax: \$0.89/100

Below the Route 288 corridor, Chesterfield gets more spread out and more affordable. Areas like Matoaca, Ettrick, and Chester offer established neighborhoods at lower price points. Manchester High School and Thomas Dale High School serve this area. Colonial Heights (independent city) borders to the south. Best for buyers on a tighter budget who want Chesterfield County services.

Budget-Friendly

Established

Commuter Access

Goochland Tax Math: A \$600K home in Goochland = \$3,180/year in property taxes. That same home in Richmond City = \$7,200/year. Over 10 years, you save \$40,200. And you get 5 acres instead of a 0.1-acre city lot.

New Kent & Charles City

East of Richmond | \$350K-450K | Tax: \$0.70-0.80/100

The eastern frontier. New Kent is growing along the I-64 corridor toward Williamsburg. Low taxes, large lots, and a 25-35 minute commute to downtown. Colonial-era history (Jamestown, Williamsburg nearby). Charles City County offers true rural living along the James River with historic plantation estates and minimal development. Best for history lovers and buyers who want acreage near the river.

I-64 Corridor

Growing

History

Powhatan County

Southwest of Richmond | \$375K-500K | Tax: \$0.78/100

Powhatan offers the most acreage per dollar in the Richmond metro. Genuinely rural character with rolling farmland, state forest access, and a small-town county

Outer Ring at a glance

AREA	MEDIAN PRICE	TAX RATE	AVG LOT SIZE	SCHOOL DISTRICT	COMMUTE	CHARACTER
Goochland	\$500K+	\$0.53	5-25 acres	Goochland Co.	35 min	Estates, horses, luxury
Powhatan	\$375-500K	\$0.78	2-10 acres	Powhatan Co.	40 min	Rural, farmland, quiet
S. Chesterfield	\$325-425K	\$0.89	0.25-1 acre	Chesterfield Co.	25 min	Affordable, established
New Kent	\$425-500K	\$0.75	1-5 acres	New Kent Co.	30 min	Growing, I-64 corridor

Tax rates shown per \$100 of assessed value. Lot sizes are typical ranges, not minimums. Commute times to downtown Richmond during non-peak hours.

WHO SHOULD LOOK HERE

- Remote workers who don't commute daily
- Horse owners and equestrian enthusiasts
- Buyers who prioritize land and privacy over convenience
- Semi-retired or retired buyers seeking peaceful living
- Families from rural areas who want to maintain that lifestyle
- Investors looking for land appreciation plays

Miles's take: Goochland is my luxury sleeper. Some of the most beautiful properties in the entire Richmond metro sit on 10+ acres with James River views, and they cost less than a townhouse in DC. If you've got remote work flexibility and want your money to go further than anywhere else in the region, Goochland is where I'd point you first.

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- **Well & Septic:** Many properties are on private well water and septic systems. Budget for inspection and maintenance.
- **Internet:** Check specific addresses for fiber/broadband availability before committing. Coverage is expanding but spotty in some areas.
- **Grocery & Services:** Plan for 15-20 minute drives to major grocery stores in rural areas.
- **Resale Market:** Niche properties on large lots take longer to sell. Know your exit timeline.
- **HOAs:** Rare in the outer ring. That's a pro or con depending on your perspective.

Not sure which suburb is right?

Send me your priorities and I'll build the comparison. mamsnow.com/connect

PART 4

The Practical Stuff

Everything Google doesn't tell you about moving to Richmond. Taxes, DMV transfers, utilities, healthcare, weather, and the personal property tax that catches every relocater off guard.

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Cost of Living Breakdown

Richmond's cost of living index is 93 (U.S. average = 100). Translation: your dollar goes 7% further here than the national average, and 15-30% further than DC, Charlotte, or Raleigh.

CATEGORY	RICHMOND	DC	CHARLOTTE	RALEIGH	NASHVILLE
Overall	93	152	101	103	105
Housing	82	220	95	104	110
Groceries	98	112	99	98	96
Utilities	101	108	97	99	95
Transportation	95	130	101	98	99
Healthcare	97	110	105	103	98

Index: U.S. average = 100. Sources: BLS, C2ER Cost of Living Index 2025. Lower numbers = more affordable.

WHAT YOU'LL ACTUALLY SPEND

- **Mortgage (median home, \$450K):**
~\$2,650/month (6.5% rate, 20% down)
- **Property tax:** \$3,200-\$5,400/year depending on county
- **Groceries (family of 4):** \$800-\$1,000/month
- **Utilities (electric, gas, water):**
\$250-\$350/month
- **Car insurance:** \$1,400-\$1,800/year
- **Gas:** \$3.00-\$3.50/gallon (typically below national avg)

THE DC COMPARISON

If you're relocating from the DC metro area, here's the short version: your housing costs drop 40-60%. A \$750K townhouse in Arlington buys a \$450K single-family home in Short Pump with a yard, two-car garage, and access to Henrico County Public Schools. Your commute doesn't get worse (it might get better). Your grocery bill stays about the same. Your overall quality of life improves significantly. That's why Northern Virginia is Richmond's #1 feeder market for relocators.

The catch: Virginia has a personal property tax on vehicles that doesn't exist in most states. See page 67 for the full breakdown.

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Transportation & Getting Around

Richmond is a car city. Public transit exists, but most residents drive. The good news: traffic is manageable compared to any major metro, and the highway system makes cross-town travel easy.

MAJOR HIGHWAYS

- **I-95:** North-south spine. Connects to DC (2 hrs), Raleigh (2.5 hrs). Bisepts the metro east-west.
- **I-64:** East-west connector. Downtown to Short Pump (20 min). Continues to Williamsburg and Virginia Beach.
- **I-295:** Eastern bypass loop. Connects Mechanicsville to the south side without going through downtown.
- **Route 288:** Western bypass loop. Connects Short Pump to Midlothian/Moseley. Essential suburban connector.
- **Powhite Parkway (Rt 76):** Toll road connecting Midlothian to downtown. ~\$0.80 toll (E-ZPass), saves 10+ minutes.
- **Downtown Expressway:** Quick east-west connection through the city center. ~\$0.85 toll (E-ZPass).

RUSH HOUR REALITY

Peak hours are 7:30-9am and 4:30-6:30pm. The worst corridor is I-64 West (Short Pump) during evening rush. But "bad" by Richmond standards means adding 10-15 minutes to your commute. If you're coming from DC, Atlanta, or any top-20 metro, Richmond traffic will feel like a vacation.

PUBLIC TRANSIT

- **GRTC Bus:** 38 routes across the metro. Useful in the city, limited in suburbs.
- **Pulse BRT:** Bus Rapid Transit line connecting Rocketts Landing (east) to Willow Lawn (west) along Broad Street. 6.8 miles, frequent service, dedicated lanes. The closest thing Richmond has to a subway.
- **Amtrak:** Two stations (Main Street, Staples Mill). Direct to DC (2 hrs), NYC (5 hrs), Raleigh (3 hrs). Northeast Regional runs multiple daily.

RICHMOND INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT (RIC)

35+ direct destinations including NYC, Chicago, Dallas, Denver, Miami, Atlanta, Charlotte, Boston, and more. Major carriers: American, Delta, United, Southwest, JetBlue, Spirit, Breeze. The airport is 15 minutes from downtown, 25 minutes from Short Pump, and almost never has TSA lines over 20 minutes. RIC is one of the most underrated airports on the East Coast.

BIKING

- **Virginia Capital Trail:** 52-mile paved trail from Richmond to Williamsburg. One of the best bike paths in America.
- **City bike lanes:** Expanding network in the

Commute Times from every area to downtown

FROM	TO DOWNTOWN	OFF-PEAK	RUSH HOUR	BEST ROUTE
The Fan	Downtown	5 min	8 min	Broad St / Main St
Church Hill	Downtown	8 min	12 min	Broad St / I-95
Short Pump	Downtown	20 min	30-35 min	I-64 East
Glen Allen	Downtown	18 min	25-30 min	I-95 South / Broad St
Midlothian	Downtown	20 min	30-35 min	Powwhite Pkwy
Moseley	Downtown	28 min	40+ min	Rt 288 to Powwhite
Mechanicsville	Downtown	20 min	25-30 min	Rt 360 / I-295
Ashland	Downtown	28 min	35-40 min	I-95 South
Goochland	Downtown	35 min	40-45 min	Rt 250 / I-64

Times are estimates based on Google Maps typical traffic patterns. Rush hour = 7:30-9am / 4:30-6:30pm weekdays. Actual times vary by season and conditions.

Miles's take: I drive every part of this metro regularly for work. The honest truth is that Richmond traffic is easy compared to any city you've probably lived in. Even the "bad" corridors (I-64 West during evening rush, Midlothian Turnpike during school drop-off) add 10-15 minutes, not 45. If you're coming from DC, you'll feel like you've been given your life back. That said, if commute time is a dealbreaker for you, buy closer to your office. The price difference between a 15-minute commute and a 30-minute commute might be \$50-100K, and that's worth the conversation.

Need commute-specific neighborhood advice?

Tell me where you'll be working and I'll narrow your neighborhood search to what actually works.
mamsnow.com/connect

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Healthcare & Hospitals

Richmond is a major medical hub. Two academic medical centers, multiple hospital systems, and nationally ranked specialties. Healthcare access is a genuine strength of the region, regardless of which suburb you choose.

MAJOR HOSPITAL SYSTEMS

VCU Health System

Academic medical center affiliated with Virginia Commonwealth University. Level I Trauma Center (the region's only). Nationally ranked in multiple specialties. Located in downtown Richmond. Home to the Massey Comprehensive Cancer Center (NCI-designated). Major employer with 13,000+ employees.

Bon Secours Mercy Health

Largest health system in the Richmond region with 7 hospitals across the metro. Facilities in Short Pump (St. Mary's), Midlothian (St. Francis), Mechanicsville (Memorial Regional), and the city (Richmond Community). Comprehensive coverage no matter where you live.

HCA Virginia

Multiple facilities including Chippenham Hospital, Johnston-Willis Hospital (Midlothian), and Henrico Doctors' Hospital (Short Pump/Glen Allen area). Strong cardiac, orthopedic, and surgical programs.

SPECIALTY & URGENT CARE

- **Children's Hospital of Richmond at VCU:** Region's only dedicated children's hospital. Pediatric ER, NICU, and specialty clinics.
- **Sheltering Arms Institute:** Top-ranked physical rehabilitation hospital.
- **Patient First:** Walk-in urgent care chain with 15+ locations across the metro. Open evenings and weekends.
- **GoHealth Urgent Care:** Multiple suburban locations, often affiliated with Bon Secours.

BY AREA

Short Pump/Glen Allen: Henrico Doctors' Hospital, Bon Secours St. Mary's

Midlothian: Johnston-Willis, Bon Secours St. Francis

Mechanicsville: Bon Secours Memorial Regional

Downtown: VCU Medical Center (Level I Trauma)

South Side: Chippenham Hospital, CJW Medical Center

Miles's take: Healthcare access isn't something most buyers think about until they need it. In Richmond, you're covered. Every suburban area has a hospital within 15 minutes. VCU Health is nationally recognized. And if you have kids, the Children's Hospital at VCU is the safety net

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Weather & Climate

Richmond has four distinct seasons. Summers are hot and humid. Winters are mild. Spring and fall are gorgeous. If you're coming from the Northeast, you'll love the shorter winters. If you're coming from Florida, pack a coat.

AVERAGE HIGH / LOW

Summer: 89F / 69F
Fall: 68F / 47F
Winter: 48F / 29F
Spring: 68F / 47F

ANNUAL AVERAGES

Rainfall: 44 inches
Snowfall: 10 inches
Sunny Days: 211
Humidity: Moderate-High

GROWING SEASON

Length: 200+ days
Zone: 7b (USDA)
Last Frost: Mid-April
First Frost: Late October

SEASON BY SEASON

SPRING (MARCH - MAY)

Richmond's best season. Cherry blossoms at Maymont, tulips at Lewis Ginter, perfect outdoor weather. Temperatures swing from 55F to 80F. Pollen is intense for 2-3 weeks in April (Richmond is in the top 10 for allergies). Pack antihistamines.

SUMMER (JUNE - AUGUST)

Hot and humid. 90F+ days are common June through August. The James River becomes the city's escape. Everyone is on the water, in the pools, or at the breweries with outdoor seating. Thunderstorms roll through regularly. Air conditioning is non-negotiable.

FALL (SEPTEMBER - NOVEMBER)

Spectacular. The Blue Ridge foliage is a 2-hour drive. Local fall colors peak mid-October through early November. Football season, apple picking, and Richmond's best event calendar (Folk Festival, State Fair). Temperatures are perfect: 50-75F.

WINTER (DECEMBER - FEBRUARY)

Mild by Northeast standards. Snow is rare (average 10 inches/year) and usually melts within 48 hours. Temperatures hover in the 40s-50s most days, with occasional cold snaps into the 20s. The city shuts down for 2+ inches of snow because it rarely happens. If you own snow tires, you probably won't need them.

The humidity caveat: July and August humidity is real. If you're coming from a dry climate (Colorado, Arizona, PNW), the adjustment takes one summer. Locals manage with pools, river access, and breweries. By September, you'll understand

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Your Relocation Checklist

Moving to a new state involves more than finding a house. This checklist covers what Virginia requires and what most people forget. Tear this page out (or screenshot it).

BEFORE YOU MOVE

- [] Research neighborhoods using this guide (you're already here)
- [] Talk to a Richmond agent before you tour anything
- [] Get pre-approved with a Virginia-licensed lender
- [] If renting first: start search 60-90 days before move date
- [] Request school records for children (transcripts, IEP docs)
- [] Get copies of medical records and prescriptions
- [] Research Virginia car insurance requirements (minimum liability: 25/50/20)
- [] Notify current utility providers of disconnect date
- [] Forward mail via USPS (start 2 weeks before move)

FIRST 30 DAYS IN VIRGINIA

- [] **DMV (within 60 days):** Get a Virginia driver's license. Bring: out-of-state license, SSN, 2 proofs of VA residency (utility bill, lease, bank statement). \$32 for 8-year license.
- [] **Vehicle Registration (within 30 days):** Register your vehicle at DMV. Bring: title or out-of-state registration, proof of

VOTER REGISTRATION

- [] Register to vote at vote.virginia.gov
- [] Deadline: 22 days before any election
- [] Can register at DMV when getting your VA license
- [] Virginia has no party registration (open primaries)

UTILITIES TO SET UP

- [] **Electric:** Dominion Energy (most areas) or Rappahannock Electric Coop (some rural areas)
- [] **Gas:** Virginia Natural Gas or Columbia Gas
- [] **Water:** County or city water authority (varies by location)
- [] **Internet:** Comcast/Xfinity, Verizon Fios (available in most suburbs), T-Mobile Home Internet
- [] **Trash:** Included in county/city taxes (no separate bill in most areas)

SCHOOLS ENROLLMENT

- [] Contact your county's school district central office
- [] Bring: proof of residency, birth certificate, immunization records, previous school records
- [] Virginia immunization requirements may differ from your current state. Check with

Moving Timeline month by month

3 MONTHS BEFORE

- Start neighborhood research (this guide)
- Connect with a Richmond real estate agent
- Get mortgage pre-approval
- Begin home search or rental search
- Research schools if you have children
- Start purging / donating items you won't move

2 MONTHS BEFORE

- Book moving company or reserve truck (summer = peak)
- Begin packing non-essential items
- Notify current landlord if renting (check lease terms)
- Transfer or close local memberships (gym, etc.)
- Start transferring medical records
- Visit Richmond if possible (neighborhood tours)

1 MONTH BEFORE

- Confirm moving company or truck reservation
- Set up Virginia utilities (electric, gas, water, internet)
- Forward mail via USPS
- Get Virginia car insurance quotes
- Pack remaining non-essentials

MOVING WEEK

- Final walkthrough of new home
- Closing day (if buying)
- Clean old home, turn in keys
- Pack essentials bag: documents, medications, chargers, toiletries
- Take photos of everything before movers load

FIRST WEEK IN RICHMOND

- Unpack essentials and set up beds/kitchen first
- Introduce yourself to neighbors (Richmond is friendly)
- Locate nearest grocery, pharmacy, urgent care
- Schedule DMV appointment (do this early, lines are real)
- Get Virginia car insurance and vehicle inspection
- Enroll kids in school
- Explore your neighborhood on foot

Miles's take: The DMV line is the one thing about Virginia that will test your patience. Book an appointment online at dmv.virginia.gov. Walk-ins can wait 2-3 hours. With an appointment, you're in and out in 30 minutes. Also: if you're buying a home, I coordinate with your lender, inspector, and attorney to make sure closing day goes smoothly. You focus on packing. I'll handle the Richmond side.

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Virginia Tax Guide

Virginia's tax structure has some surprises. Income tax is moderate. Sales tax is low. But the personal property tax on vehicles is unique and catches every relocater off guard. Here's the full picture.

VIRGINIA INCOME TAX

TAXABLE INCOME	RATE
\$0 - \$3,000	2%
\$3,001 - \$5,000	3%
\$5,001 - \$17,000	5%
\$17,001+	5.75%

Standard deduction: \$8,500 (single), \$17,000 (married filing jointly). Virginia has no local income tax.

HOW VIRGINIA COMPARES

STATE	TOP RATE	NOTES
Virginia	5.75%	Flat above \$17K
DC	10.75%	Progressive, higher brackets
Maryland	5.75%	Plus local income tax (2-3.2%)
North Carolina	4.5%	Flat rate
Tennessee	0%	No income tax

SALES TAX

General rate: 6% (4.3% state + 1% local + 0.7% regional) in Richmond metro
Hampton Roads region: 7.5% (includes transit surcharge)
Food (groceries): 1% (reduced rate)
No sales tax on: Prescription drugs, most clothing under \$100 during tax-free weekends

PROPERTY TAX (REAL ESTATE)

Virginia property taxes are set by each locality. The rate is applied per \$100 of assessed value. Assessed value is typically close to fair market value, reassessed annually or biennially.

LOCALITY	RATE PER \$100	\$400K HOME	\$600K HOME
Goochland	\$0.53	\$2,120	\$3,180
Hanover	\$0.81	\$3,240	\$4,860
Henrico	\$0.83	\$3,320	\$4,980
Chesterfield	\$0.89	\$3,560	\$5,340
Richmond City	\$1.20	\$4,800	\$7,200

No estate tax: Virginia has no state estate or inheritance tax. For retirees planning wealth

The Personal Property Tax (Yes, Really)

This is the tax that surprises every relocater. Virginia assesses a personal property tax on your vehicles annually. It's based on the vehicle's assessed value and your county's tax rate. Plan for it.

HOW IT WORKS

- Your county assesses the value of each vehicle you own (using NADA or similar guides)
- A tax rate is applied per \$100 of assessed value
- You receive a bill annually (or semi-annually in some jurisdictions)
- Applies to: cars, trucks, motorcycles, boats, trailers, and RVs
- Virginia provides partial relief through the Personal Property Tax Relief Act (PPTRA), which reduces the bill for qualifying vehicles

PERSONAL PROPERTY TAX RATES

LOCALITY	RATE PER \$100
Richmond City	\$3.70
Henrico	\$3.35
Chesterfield	\$3.25
Hanover	\$3.57
Goochland	\$4.00

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLES

2023 Toyota Camry

Assessed:
~\$22,000
Henrico tax: ~\$770
After PPTRA relief:
~\$500-600

2024 Tesla Model Y

Assessed:
~\$40,000
Henrico tax:
~\$1,400
After PPTRA relief:
~\$1,000-1,200

2021 Honda CR-V

Assessed:
~\$25,000
Chesterfield tax:
~\$900
After PPTRA relief:
~\$600-700

2020 Ford F-150

Assessed:
~\$30,000
Hanover tax:
~\$1,071
After PPTRA relief:
~\$750-850

Miles's take: The personal property tax is the #1 thing that catches my relocating clients off guard. Plan for \$500-\$1,500 per vehicle per year depending on the car's value and your county. Yes, it stings. But Virginia has no local income tax, lower sales tax, and no estate tax, which offsets it for most households. Budget for it and it won't be a surprise.

PRO TIP

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Richmond Food & Drink Guide

Richmond is a legitimate top-tier food city. Multiple James Beard Award semifinalists, 30+ craft breweries, and a dining scene that punches way above its weight class. This is not a comprehensive list. It's a starter pack.

FINE DINING & SPECIAL OCCASION

- **Brenner Pass** - Alpine-inspired, James Beard semifinalist. The Fan.
- **The Roosevelt** - Southern elevated, Church Hill. James Beard semifinalist.
- **Longoven** - Tasting menu, Scott's Addition. One of RVA's most creative kitchens.
- **L'Opossum** - Eccentric fine dining, Oregon Hill. Unforgettable experience.
- **Shagbark** - Farm-to-table, Midlothian Turnpike. Beautiful space.
- **Lillie Pearl** - Southern-Asian fusion, Chef Mike Lindsey. New Brook Rd location.
- **Lemaire** - Classic American, inside the Jefferson Hotel. Power dinner spot.

RICHMOND INSTITUTIONS

- **Mama J's** - Soul food, Jackson Ward. The fried chicken is legendary.
- **Kuba Kuba** - Cuban cafe, The Fan. Perpetual line, always worth it.
- **Can Can Brasserie** - French bistro, Carytown. Sunday brunch institution.
- **Lillie Pearl** - Southern-Asian fusion, Brook Rd. Chef Mike Lindsey.
- **Joe's Inn** - Italian-American, The Fan. Spaghetti a la Joe's is iconic.
- **Dot's Back Inn** - Neighborhood diner, Northside. Cash only, no pretense.

CRAFT BREWERIES (TOP 10)

- **The Veil Brewing** - Hazy IPAs, Scott's Addition. National reputation.
- **Vasen Brewing** - Saisons, farmhouse ales. Beautiful taproom.
- **Ardent Craft Ales** - Scott's Addition anchor. Solid lineup.
- **Triple Crossing** - IPAs, Fulton location + downtown. James Beard semifinalist.
- **The Answer Brewpub** - Experimental, massive tap list. Scott's Addition.
- **Strangeways Brewing** - Creative styles, Dabney Rd. Dog-friendly.
- **Center of the Universe** - Ashland's anchor brewery. Great space.
- **Starr Hill** - Charlottesville original, Scott's Addition taproom.
- **Bingo Beer Co.** - Lagers, easy drinking. Scott's Addition.
- **Hardywood Park** - Richmond original. GBS (Gingerbread Stout) is an annual event.

COFFEE

- **Lamplighter Coffee** - The Fan, Addison St. Richmond's flagship.
- **Ironclad Coffee Roasters** - Shockoe Bottom, John Rolfe Pkwy. Small-batch.
- **Blanchards Coffee** - Multiple locations. Consistent quality.

Where to Eat by neighborhood

THE FAN / CARYTOWN

- Can Can Brasserie (French)
- Kuba Kuba (Cuban)
- Edo's Squid (Italian BYOB)
- The Jasper (cocktails)
- Joe's Inn (Italian-American)
- Helen's (Southern brunch)
- Little Nickel (bar food)

CHURCH HILL

- The Roosevelt (Southern)
- Alewife (seafood)
- Sub Rosa Bakery (bread)
- Alamo BBQ (BBQ)
- Dutch & Co. (cocktails)

SCOTT'S ADDITION

- Brenner Pass (Alpine)
- Longoven (tasting menu)
- ZZQ (Texas BBQ)
- Lunch. / Supper. (comfort)
- The Veil (brewery)
- Vasen (brewery)
- Gelati Celesti (gelato)

JACKSON WARD

- Mama J's (soul food)
- Lillie Pearl (Southern-Asian)
- Saison (French market)
- The Hop Craft (pizza/beer)

SHORT PUMP

- Peter Chang's (Sichuan)
- Kabana (Indian rooftop)
- Liberty Public House (pub)
- Tazza Kitchen (farm table)
- Cooper's Hawk (wine/dining)

MIDLOTHIAN

- The Boathouse (waterfront)
- Sedona Taphouse (gastropub)
- Shagbark (farm table)
- Latitude Seafood (seafood)
- Carmello's (Italian)

ASHLAND

- Iron Horse (upscale)
- Homemades by Suzanne
- CotU Brewing (beer)
- Ashland Coffee (live music)



17th Street Farmers Market, Shockoe Bottom. Photo: Ron Cogswell, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

Miles's take: Richmond's food scene is one of the reasons I love living here. We have James Beard semifinalists operating in converted warehouses next to nationally ranked breweries. The price point is incredible compared to DC or New York. A date-night dinner at a top restaurant here runs \$80-120

PART 4: THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Annual Events Calendar

Richmond has something happening almost every weekend. Here's your month-by-month guide to the events that define the city's culture.

JANUARY

Richmond Restaurant Week (prix fixe menus at 100+ restaurants). Martin Luther King Jr. Day celebrations. College basketball season at VCU and U of R.

FEBRUARY

Valentine's Day restaurant scene. Hardywood GBS Day (Gingerbread Stout release, lines wrap the block). Richmond Wine Festival at Meadow Event Park.

MARCH

Shamrock the Block (St. Patrick's Day celebration). Lewis Ginter spring flower shows begin. Cherry blossom season at Maymont. Spring farmer's markets open.

APRIL

Monument Avenue 10K (25,000+ runners, biggest single-day event). Historic Garden Week (statewide home and garden tours). Easter on Parade in Carytown. James River tubing season begins.

MAY

Dominion Energy Riverrock (3-day outdoor

JULY

Fourth of July at Dogwood Dell (fireworks over Byrd Park). James River is packed every weekend. Richmond Flying Squirrels baseball all summer. Kings Dominion at peak season.

AUGUST

Back-to-school. The hottest month. Watermelon Festival at Hanover Tomato Festival. Late-summer brewery events. Richmond Restaurant Week (second round).

SEPTEMBER

State Fair of Virginia (Meadow Event Park, Doswell, 2 weeks). Carytown Watermelon Festival (biggest one-day food event). Football season kicks off. Weather perfection begins.

OCTOBER

Richmond Folk Festival (free, 3 days, Brown's Island, 200,000+ attendees). Fall foliage peaks. Apple picking at Carter Mountain (Charlottesville day trip). Pumpkin patches open everywhere. First Fridays Art Walk in Jackson Ward.

Recurring Events year-round

WEEKLY

- **Farmer's Markets:** South of the James (Saturdays), Bryan Park (Saturdays), Birdhouse (Sundays, Bellevue). Seasonal: April-November.
- **Friday Cheers:** Free outdoor concert series, Brown's Island. May-September. Richmond's unofficial summer tradition.
- **Flying Squirrels Baseball:** AA affiliate, The Diamond (new stadium coming). April-September. Affordable, family-friendly.

MONTHLY

- **First Fridays:** Art Walk in the Broad Street arts district. Galleries, live music, food, street vendors. Year-round.
- **2nd Street Festival:** Jackson Ward celebration of African American culture and community. Arts, music, food. Biannual (spring and fall).
- **RVA Big Market:** Maker's market showcasing local artisans. Monthly locations vary.

RICHMOND SPORTS

- **Richmond Kickers:** Professional soccer (USL League One), City Stadium
- **VCU Rams Basketball:** Atlantic 10 Conference, Siegel Center. Electric atmosphere.
- **U of R Spiders:** Football, basketball (A-10), campus events
- **NASCAR at Richmond Raceway:** Two Cup Series race weekends per year
- **Kings Dominion:** Theme park, March-October (Doswell)



Photo: Eli Christman, CC BY 2.0

DAY TRIPS FROM RICHMOND

Charlottesville (1 hr) - Wineries, UVA, Carter Mountain orchards

Virginia Beach (1.5 hrs) - Atlantic coast beaches

Williamsburg (1 hr) - Colonial history, Busch Gardens

Shenandoah Valley (2 hrs) - Skyline Drive, Blue Ridge hiking

Washington DC (2 hrs) - Museums, monuments, dining

Outer Banks (3.5 hrs) - Beach vacation

Wintergreen Resort (1.5 hrs) - Skiing, golf, mountain retreat

Miles's take: Richmond's events calendar is genuinely stacked. The Folk Festival alone is worth the move. 200,000 people on Brown's Island for three days of free music, and you can walk home to Church Hill or bike back to the Fan. Dominion Riverrock turns the entire James River corridor into an outdoor festival. And Friday Cheers every week all summer is the kind of thing that makes you text your friends in other cities with "you

PART 5

Your Next Move

You've done the research. You know the neighborhoods, the numbers, and the lifestyle. Here's how to turn that knowledge into your perfect home.

PART 5: YOUR NEXT MOVE

5 Steps to Finding Your Perfect Place

1 Start With a Conversation

Before you look at a single listing, let's talk. I'll learn about your lifestyle, priorities, budget, and timeline. We'll narrow your search to 2-3 neighborhoods that actually fit, so you're not wasting weekends touring homes in areas that aren't right. This call saves my clients an average of 6-8 weeks of unfocused searching.

2 Get Pre-Approved

I connect you with Virginia-licensed lenders who understand the Richmond market. Pre-approval tells you exactly what you can afford and makes your offers competitive. In a market where homes move in 15-30 days, being pre-approved isn't optional. I have lender relationships that get my clients to the front of the line.

3 Tour with Purpose

I don't do drive-by tours. For every home, I'll walk you through the neighborhood, the school zone, the commute reality, and the street-level details that don't show up on Zillow. For out-of-state clients, I do detailed video walkthroughs with live commentary so you can make informed decisions remotely. Every client gets my honest assessment, not a sales pitch.

4 Negotiate & Win

When you find the one, I build a competitive offer strategy based on real market data. I'll tell you when to push, when to hold, and when to walk away. My negotiation approach is data-driven, not emotional. I've saved clients tens of thousands by knowing what a home is actually worth versus what it's listed at. New construction? I negotiate upgrades, lot premiums, and contract protections the builder's agent won't tell you about.

5 Close & Settle In

I coordinate with your lender, inspector, appraiser, and settlement attorney to make closing seamless. But it doesn't stop at the closing table. I stay connected. Need a contractor? An electrician? A restaurant recommendation for your anniversary? I'm a text away. My clients from 3 years ago still reach out, and I still answer. That's the relationship.

PART 5: YOUR NEXT MOVE

What MAMS Clients Say

Don't take my word for it. Here's what real clients have said after working with me.

"We moved across the US from the West to the East Coast. Miles walked with us for over 6 months long after the closing to make sure we were able to get into our house and settled. He has been with us and supported us every step of the way and is now considered a friend to our family."

Cross-Country Relocator | Zillow 5-Star Review

"Miles is the absolute best! My wife and I were first time home buyers in the wildest market conditions anyone has ever seen, and he guided us through the whole process better than I could have ever asked for. He is professional, friendly, knowledgeable, and will work HARD for you! He responded to us at all hours of the day."

First-Time Buyers | Zillow 5-Star Review

"Miles Agee was always working for me to find a home to buy. I was relocating to the Richmond, VA area from Northern Virginia. If I found homes available online and I wanted to see it, Miles always made himself available. He is very knowledgeable of the area which helped me since I did not know the area."

NoVA to Richmond Relocator | Zillow 5-Star Review

"Miles is the best thing that could have happened to us. He was always available and quick to respond, knowledgeable about the market and home buying process, and full of recommendations from coffee to electricians. Miles' abundant excitement and energy made the stressful process enjoyable."

Richmond Homebuyers | Zillow 5-Star Review

"Miles has been super helpful during our buying process. He went out of his way to do multiple virtual tours, as we were living outside Richmond. Many things changed along our home buying process, BUT we finally found the right home and closed! Miles is still like family to us even after closing."

Out-of-Town Buyer | Zillow 5-Star Review

"Miles is amazing! He was so knowledgeable about everything and if he didn't know, he would make sure to find out ASAP! The whole process went quickly and he went above and beyond. I highly recommend him and his company. He is truly an amazing person."

Buyer Client | Zillow 5-Star Review

PART 5: YOUR NEXT MOVE

About Miles



I'm Miles Agee, licensed Realtor and founder of MAMS Real Estate. I've helped families buy and sell homes across every neighborhood in this guide. I know this city block by block because I've walked it, driven it, and lived it.

My approach is different from most agents. I don't start with listings. I start with you. Your lifestyle. Your priorities. Your budget. Then I match you to the right neighborhood before we ever open Zillow. This saves months of unfocused searching and prevents the most common mistake relocators make: buying in the wrong area because nobody told them the differences.

I specialize in relocating buyers, first-time homebuyers, and sellers who want maximum value. I leverage data, technology, and genuine neighborhood expertise to give my clients an advantage. If you've gotten this far in the guide, you already know I don't do surface-level. I go deep. That's how I serve my clients too.

THE MAMS DIFFERENCE

- Neighborhood-level expertise across the entire Richmond metro
- Data-driven pricing and negotiation strategy
- Video walkthroughs and virtual tours for remote buyers
- Post-closing support: contractors, vendors, local recommendations
- Responsive communication at all hours
- Relationships that last long after the

READY?

Tell Me What You're Looking For

Tell me about your lifestyle, your priorities, and your timeline. I'll match you to the right neighborhoods and build a search strategy that saves you time, money, and stress.

Website: mamsnow.com/connect

Email: miles@milesagee.com

Phone: (804) 409-8340

Instagram: [@maborealtor](https://www.instagram.com/maborealtor)

TikTok: [@maborealtor](https://www.tiktok.com/@maborealtor)

TAKE THE QUIZ

Answer 5 questions and get personalized neighborhood recommendations.
mamsnow.com/quiz

FOLLOW ALONG

Daily Richmond content, market updates, and behind-the-scenes on Instagram and TikTok.
[@maborealtor](https://www.instagram.com/maborealtor)

No pressure. No obligation. Just a conversation about what you're looking for and how I can help.



MAMS Real Estate

Richmond, Virginia

mamsnow.com

miles@milesagee.com

[@maborealtor](#)

v2.0 | 2026 Edition

Data current as of Q1 2026. Market conditions change. Always
verify with a local professional before making decisions.

Built with intention. Designed to convert.

MAMS LLC | Licensed in Virginia